The Hipstraw Market Mastery Playbook

Oct 13, 2026 · @Ashish

Version 0.1 · October 2026 · Candidate doctrine, not qualified. How to choose the right Strategy, Play, Line and Move for every Market Position, for Market Managers, Campaign Managers, Market Architects, sponsors and the agents they supervise.

`Position + Stance → Strategy → Play → Line → Move · Gambit → Action → Verify → Review again`

16	32	20	56 + 12	60	20	7	6
Strategies	Plays	Lines	Moves and Gambits	Actions	Hard rules	Compatibility matrices	Worked cases

> **Status.** Every Strategy, Play, Line, Move, Gambit and Action here is a candidate from the *Hipstraw Market Mastery Master Workbook v0.2* (13 October 2026). This playbook is the field edition of that workbook: it keeps the workbook's IDs and rules, adds stance compatibility, Line steps as Move and Action IDs, and example thresholds. Nothing here is field-qualified doctrine or authority to contact, spend, publish, hire or commit. All cases are synthetic teaching worlds.

0 How to use this playbook

This playbook helps the people and agents who develop markets choose the next move quickly and check that it is allowed. Agents follow the same rules. Find the right choice in Parts A–C, then read the card in Part D for the detail.

Three ways in

I know which Position is weak	I see a signal in the market	I know the market type
Need unproven, buyers unreachable, supply breaking, margin falling…	“Interesting” but no action, sign-ups with no activation, a partner promising reach…	New category, fragmented local services, two-sided, enterprise design partner, regional entry…
Go to §7.1 Position × Stance, then §6 Quick picker.	Go to §8 Situation finder. It names the Play and the first Move.	Go to §7.7 Market type × Play: where the first win usually is and the typical trap.

How to read a card

Field	What it tells you
Header	ID, plain name and status.
One line	What it achieves.
Use when / Don’t use when	Signals that make it fit, and the cases where it must not be used.
Must be true	Evidence, permission and authority required before it starts. If any is missing, stop.
Stance	Default stance, those allowed, and those never allowed.
Links	Strategies, Plays, Lines, Moves and Actions above and below it in the grammar.
Who decides	The accountable owner and who must approve.
Done when	The success test. Progress counts only when verified in an authoritative source.
Example · Pioneer’s tip	A synthetic case and one practical recommendation.

Legend. ● default · ○ allowed · × never · blank = not typical. IDs: **H-Sxx** Strategy · **H-Pxx** Play · **H-Lxx** Line · **H-Mxx** Move · **H-Gxx** Gambit · **H-Axx** Action · **MP1–MP7** Market Position axes · **AR01–AR16** market types · **Gate 0–5** evidence gates. The “H-” prefix is dropped in tables.

> **Two renames from the workbook.** Market archetypes are written **AR01–AR16** (the workbook's A01–A16 collide with Actions), and evidence gates are written **Gate 0–5** (the workbook's G0–G5 collide with Gambits). Everything else keeps its workbook ID.

Part A · The basics

The grammar, the seven Market Positions and the eight Stances: everything the agent reads before it chooses.

1 The grammar on one page

Position and Stance are read first. Strategy, Play, Line, Move and Action form a chain from the outcome down to the logged task. A Gambit is a special kind of Move. Every chain ends in verification and a new Review, because a sent message is not market progress.

Term	What it is	Football analogy	In Case C1 (vertical B2B SaaS)	How often
Position	The evidence-backed, uncertainty-qualified state of one bounded market unit, read on seven axes (MP1–MP7).	The scoreboard and the pitch	Need a strong hypothesis for RevOps, weak for CIOs · offer still a concept · economics not modeled	Always read first
Stance	The short-term professional behaviour chosen for the current situation.	How hard the team presses today	Probe; Activate and Expand ruled out until the need and offer are proven	Chosen per Review
Strategy	The market outcome the principal intends to cause.	The game plan for this match	Prioritize a market wedge, then create a credible first commitment	Selective

Term	What it is	Football analogy	In Case C1 (vertical B2B SaaS)	How often
Play	A recognized market situation and its response family.	A formation from the playbook	Vertical Wedge Selection	Earned
Line	A conditional plan of Moves with branches, a time window, stop rules and a done test.	A rehearsed set piece, with options	Wedge Selection, then Design Partner Loop	Normal unit of work
Move	One purposeful intervention meant to change the Position.	A pass	Ask two RevOps teams for a paid design-partner slot	Purposeful
Gambit	A Move that deliberately gives something up for a bigger gain, with a capped loss and a named approver.	Pulling the keeper for an extra attacker	Paid design-partner discount: 40% off $20,000, max loss $16,000 for two partners	Rare
Action	One auditable, logged effect in a system or in the field.	The kick itself	Mapped 4 approvers; security is the veto	Frequent
Mission	A scoped assignment for a human Market Architect or an agent.	Sending on a specialist	A Research Architect sits in on month-end close at 3 RevOps teams to cost the exception burden	Per field need
Recommended next step	The top-ranked allowed option right now.	The coach's next call	Offer two RevOps teams an 8-week paid design-partner slot at $12,000	Always shown

Which level is it?

Question	Level
Just an auditable step under an existing approval?	Action
A purposeful intervention that changes a Position?	Move
It knowingly gives something up, with a bounded loss?	Gambit
Several Moves needing order, branches and stop rules?	Line
A recognized, repeatable market situation?	Play
A sustained outcome we are trying to cause?	Strategy

> **Strategy is not Stance.** Strategy is the outcome: “Create a credible first commitment.” Stance is the behaviour: “Probe.” They combine within limits. You can ask for a commitment gently, but you still ask for something that costs the buyer effort.

> **Observation is an Action, not a Move.** Recording a field observation, coding an interview or storing a source establishes the Position. The first Move is whatever changes it: a commitment ask, an introduction, a throttle, a stop.

The loop. Reality → Review → Position → Attention → Action → Outcome → Review again. Exploring, developing, building and scaling are different repertoires inside this one loop. The Review, not the chat, dashboard or campaign tool, is the interface to reality.

2 Positions and their states

A Market Position describes one bounded market unit on seven independent axes. The unit is: principal × offer × buying archetype × job × territory × route × time horizon. “The India market” is too broad to hold a Position; “appliance repair for working households in two Bengaluru neighborhoods, booked through local intermediaries” is not.

> **Rules for reading a Position.** (1) The seven axes are independent. Never collapse them into one score: a strong axis never hides a weak one. (2) Each Review names the **binding constraint**, the axis that most limits progress now. Its state sets the default stance (§7.1). (3) Missing evidence means **Unknown**, never the worst state and never the best. (4) Only the Market Manager's governed Market Review changes the consolidated Position. Campaigns, Missions and specialists send Impact Signals. (5) Two market units are never merged to make an aggregate look better.

2.1 The seven axes

Axis	Screen name	Registry name	What it manages	States (screen · registry)
MP1	Need	Opportunity Position	Problem intensity, unmet job, substitutes, timing, willingness to change	Not mapped · UNMAPPED → Hypothesis · HYPOTHESIZED → Supported · SUPPORTED → Contested · DISPUTED / Rejected · REJECTED
MP2	Buyers & access	Audience Position	Who buys, who influences, how to reach them with permission and trust	Unknown · UNKNOWN → Reachable · ACCESSIBLE → Engaged · ENGAGED → Converting · CONVERTING / Can't reach · INACCESSIBLE
MP3	Offer	Offer Position	Proposition, differentiation, real value, risk and purchase friction	Concept · CONCEPT → Prototype · PROTOTYPE → Tested · TESTED → Fits · FITTING / Misfits · MISFITTING

Axis	Screen name	Registry name	What it manages	States (screen · registry)
MP4	Route to market	Route-to-Market Position	Channels, partners, creators, sales motions and distribution agreements	Untested · UNTESTED → Piloting · PILOTING → Repeatable · REPEATABLE → Saturated · SATURATED / Blocked · BLOCKED
MP5	Delivery system	Market System Position	Supply, fulfillment, liquidity, incentives, regulation, community	Fragile · FRAGILE → Working · FUNCTIONAL → Reliable · RELIABLE → Resilient · RESILIENT / Broken · BROKEN
MP6	Economics	Economic Position	Contribution margin, acquisition cost, payback, capacity, retention, cash	Not modeled · UNMODELED → Assumed · ASSUMPTION → Observed · OBSERVED → Viable · VIABLE / Negative · NEGATIVE
MP7	Repeatability & scale	Scale and Institutional Position	Transferability, repeatable repertoire, portfolio options	First of its kind · NOVEL → Repeatable · REPEATABLE → Transferable · TRANSFERABLE → Scaled · SCALED / Regressing · REGRESSING

2.2 What each state usually calls for

Axis	State	Shows when	Usually calls for
MP1 Need	Not mapped	No specific job, actor or substitute has been observed.	S01
MP1 Need	Hypothesis	A specific testable job exists, from desk work or anecdote.	S02 · S03

Axis	State	Shows when	Usually calls for
MP1 Need	Supported	Independent target buyers showed costly behaviour, not just interest.	S05 · S06
MP1 Need	Contested	Behaviour and claims conflict, or disconfirming cases are material.	S02
MP1 Need	Rejected	A genuine test failed and no cheap test remains.	S16
MP2 Buyers	Unknown	Buying roles or reachable sources are not identified.	S01 · S04
MP2 Buyers	Reachable	Qualified people can be contacted with permission.	S05 · S06
MP2 Buyers	Engaged	Qualified people respond and take part.	S06 · S07
MP2 Buyers	Converting	Qualified buyers complete paid or committed transactions in a defined cohort.	S09 · S10
MP2 Buyers	Can't reach	Access fails after a fair test of routes.	S04 · S08
MP3 Offer	Concept	Proposition described, not experienced.	S05 · S07
MP3 Offer	Prototype	Buyers can try a narrow version.	S05 · S06
MP3 Offer	Tested	Comprehension and trial evidence exist.	S06
MP3 Offer	Fits	Paid use with acceptable churn in the target archetype.	S09 · S10
MP3 Offer	Misfits	The same valid objection recurs across qualified prospects.	S02 (via P18) · S16
MP4 Route	Untested	No route has run a capped test.	S04 · S08
MP4 Route	Piloting	A route is in a bounded test.	S08 · S06
MP4 Route	Repeatable	The same route delivered healthy cohorts twice.	S10 · S15
MP4 Route	Saturated	Marginal returns fall or the same people see repeated outreach.	S10 (via P25) · S12

Axis	State	Shows when	Usually calls for
MP4 Route	Blocked	A rule, partner or platform closes the route.	S04 · S16
MP5 Delivery	Fragile	Supply, quality or fulfillment is unproven or thin.	S09 · S11
MP5 Delivery	Working	Transactions complete, with visible defects.	S09 · S11
MP5 Delivery	Reliable	Fill rate, quality and complaints meet the agreed gates.	S10
MP5 Delivery	Resilient	Reliability holds under stress or a new cohort.	S15
MP5 Delivery	Broken	Safety, quality or availability fails a gate.	S16 (pause) · S11 (repair)
MP6 Economics	Not modeled	No cost-to-serve or acquisition model exists.	S03 · S12
MP6 Economics	Assumed	A model exists; no real cohort has tested it.	S06 · S12
MP6 Economics	Observed	Real cohort costs and revenue are measured.	S10 · S12
MP6 Economics	Viable	Incremental contribution and payback are positive and reproducible.	S10 · S15
MP6 Economics	Negative	Contribution is negative after every real cost.	S12 · S16
MP7 Scale	First of its kind	No repeat yet.	S09 · S10
MP7 Scale	Repeatable	Two or more independent cohorts or periods succeeded.	S15 (transfer test)
MP7 Scale	Transferable	A held-out new segment or region succeeded.	S15
MP7 Scale	Scaled	Staged scale passed Gate 5.	S10 · S14
MP7 Scale	Regressing	Scaled results decline in quality or margin.	S12 · S16 (via P31)

2.3 The six evidence gates

The four disciplines (Explore, Develop, Build, Scale) advance only through these gates. A gate is passed by evidence, never by calendar.

Gate	Discipline	Required evidence	If not met
Gate 0 · Opportunity	Explore	Traceable need signals plus contrary cases	Reframe or park
Gate 1 · Behavioural demand	Develop	Commitment beyond declared intent, in a sample fit for the decision	Broaden the sample or change the offer
Gate 2 · Delivery	Build	Paid, completed customer value and safe supply	Fix fulfillment before promotion
Gate 3 · Repeatability	Build	Two or more independent cohort or period checks, credible contribution	Limit spend; diagnose the channel mix
Gate 4 · Transfer	Scale	Held-out test in a new segment or region, local compliance, a named owner	Pilot the new market; no mass launch
Gate 5 · Scaled operation	Scale	Capacity, quality, incremental economics, retention and a counterfactual	Throttle; return to Gate 2 or 3

2.4 Attention and disposition

Every Review ends with an attention tier and a disposition, both logged.

Attention tier	Means
Ambient	Logged, nobody notified
Brief	In the next scheduled brief
Watch	A threshold or trigger is set; owner named
Prompt	Owner should look this week
Alert	Owner must look now; a gate or deadline is at risk
Request	A named person must decide by a stated time

Dispositions: **EXPLORE · TEST · ACTIVATE · BUILD · SCALE · REFRAME · PARK · STOP**. “No action” and “wait” are valid outcomes when more evidence would not change the decision.

> **How Cases shape the Position.** A Campaign or Mission never rewrites the Market Position. A Campaign can truthfully close as “10 qualified introductions achieved” while the Market Manager keeps MP4 at Piloting. Repeated findings become an Impact Signal; the Market Manager decides in a Review.

3 Stances

A Stance is short-term behaviour: how Hipstraw acts right now. It filters which Moves and Gambits are allowed and sets the tone of every message. It always stays inside the standing posture: truthful, consented, useful and economically disciplined.

> **Rules for stances.** (1) The default comes from the binding-constraint axis (§7.1). A stance marked × on any axis that applies is not allowed for that market unit. (2) A Case inherits the market's stance unless a hard rule forces Protect / Pause for that activity. (3) Different Cases on one market can carry different stances at once: research can Listen while supply Builds. (4) Every stance change is logged with a reason and a review trigger. (5) Listen and Scout never use Gambits; Protect / Pause starts no new Gambits.

Stance	Behaviour	Typical Moves	Never	Sounds like	Lasts until
Listen	Suspends persuasion; asks open, situated questions.	M01 · M02 · M04 · M17	Pitching, asking for a commitment, claiming a market exists from politeness, any Gambit.	“Walk me through the last time a repair went wrong. What did you do next?”	A specific, testable job survives negative evidence (Gate 0).
Scout	Searches for signal sources, access routes and rival hypotheses.	M05 · M06 · M07 · M15 · M19	Using desk research in place of field validation for a consequential decision; contact without permission; any Gambit.	“We're mapping who services salon equipment here. Could you introduce us to two owners willing to talk?”	A qualified, reachable route is mapped, or MP2 is marked Can't reach.

Stance	Behaviour	Typical Moves	Never	Sounds like	Lasts until
Probe	Runs a bounded test with minimal irreversible commitment.	M03 · M10 · M22 · M23 · M33	Over-reading small or biased tests; commitments beyond the test cap; exclusivity; expansion Moves.	“Would you send your next three repair requests through us this month? We’ll confirm a technician within two hours or tell you we can’t.”	The test answers its decision question, or its cap is hit.
Co-create	Develops the offer with consenting participants on fair terms.	M21 · M27 · M28 · M37	Extracting unpaid work; vague or misrepresented terms; exclusivity without approval.	“For eight weeks we build the exception workflow with your RevOps team. You pay $12,000, you can stop at week 4, and you see everything we learn.”	The partner’s real use is measured and a next decision is recorded.
Activate	Asks for a meaningful, low-risk conversion or commitment.	M10 · M33 · M35 · M41	Hiding commercial intent or consent terms; invented urgency; activating beyond verified supply.	“The pilot price is ₹499 a visit until 30 November. That is the real price, and you can cancel any time.”	The cohort completes and is verified, or a stop trigger fires.
Build	Makes fulfillment, trust and unit economics reliable.	M36 · M38 · M39 · M40 · M41 · M43 · M49	Growing demand beyond safe supply; counting bookings as delivered value.	“We’re pausing new bookings in Indiranagar this week while we add two technicians. Your booking is confirmed.”	Gate 2 and Gate 3 evidence exists.
Expand	Replicates a validated pattern with gates and holdouts.	M46 · M47 · M50 · M51 · M53	Assuming transfer to new cultures, channels or regions; subsidy that hides economics; scale without a holdout.	“Koramangala passed both gates. HSR Layout opens as a held-out test with its own stop rule before any city-wide spend.”	Gate 4 or 5 is passed, or the stop rule fires.
Protect / Pause	Preserves safety, money, consent, reputation and options.	M40 · M43 · M54 · M55	Keeping campaigns running to meet activity quotas; new outreach other than required notices and remedies; new Gambits.	“We’ve stopped all messages to this list while we confirm consent. Nobody else from us will contact you.”	The cause is fixed and a Review reopens the activity.

Part B · Hard conditions

The rules that apply to every choice, and who has the authority to decide.

4 The rules that never bend

If a rule is hit, the agent stops, holds or escalates as shown. No stance, Strategy or Gambit overrides these rules. Numbering follows the workbook.

#	Rule	Why	Example	When hit, the agent…
01	A market hypothesis is not a fact.	Confidence from anecdote drives bad spend.	Five of ten CIOs are enthusiastic; none can name a budget (C1).	Reports confidence, sample, source and counterevidence. MP1 stays at Hypothesis.
02	Research is not permission to market.	Consent to an interview does not cover sales outreach.	Interviewees from a disconfirming study are added to a campaign list.	Blocks launch for that cohort (A25) and requests opt-in (A19).
03	A lead is not a customer.	Funnel counts inflate progress.	A partner reports 1,000 leads; 60 are eligible.	Reports qualified and unknown counts separately. Invents no conversion.
04	No fabricated demand, reviews, personas or testimonials.	Destroys trust; unlawful in many places.	A creator offers to post fake testimonials (C3).	Declines. Labels every synthetic world and dataset as synthetic.
05	No manufactured social proof or false scarcity.	Deceives buyers.	“Only 3 slots left” when capacity is 30.	Refuses the creative (A23) and routes it to the brand owner.
06	No manipulation or exploitative targeting.	Protects vulnerable people.	Targeting distressed households during a local crisis (AR12).	Stops the treatment, moves to Protect / Pause, runs P26.

#	Rule	Why	Example	When hit, the agent…
07	Never ignore local law and institutional context.	Rules differ by country, sector and channel.	A country rule closes the planned campaign route (C6).	Runs P26 Permission and Compliance Review before any effect.
08	Field researchers obtain appropriate consent.	Covert capture harms participants and taints evidence.	A Scout photographs a salon interior without asking.	Quarantines the evidence; Mission goes to QA.
09	No uncontrolled outreach across channels.	Duplicate chasers annoy people; opt-outs must travel.	A campaign agent and a Market Architect contact the same owner in one week.	Keeps one contact owner per participant, suppresses the second, propagates opt-outs everywhere.
10	Missing evidence is Unknown.	Lack of response is not lack of interest.	An intermediary never forwarded the invitations; zero replies.	Marks MP2 Unknown, not Can't reach, and tests another route.
11	Human Missions have safe boundaries.	Worker safety and fair pay come first.	A worker reports an unsafe interview venue.	Ends the Mission (L17 branch), protects the worker, preserves evidence.
12	Different principals require confidentiality barriers.	Client plans and data are not shared assets.	An agent tries to reuse client A's field records for client B.	Denies access and logs the boundary.
13	Investment follows stage gates.	Spending ahead of evidence destroys value.	A partner asks for a prepaid national campaign before Gate 2.	Declines until the gates pass; routes the decision to the sponsor.
14	Every Gambit has a capped loss and a fallback.	Concessions must be deliberate and bounded.	A subsidy with no end date.	Treats the Gambit as inadmissible until max loss, end date, fallback and approver are set.

#	Rule	Why	Example	When hit, the agent…
15	Do not scale broken fulfillment.	More demand on broken supply hurts customers.	Providers cancel 15% of bookings against a 10% gate.	Runs M40 and throttles acquisition (A43); sends an MP5 Impact Signal.
16	Attribution must be truthful.	Inflated results mislead sponsors.	Booked appointments reported as revenue.	Reports pipeline, bookings, revenue, contribution and incremental lift separately (A47).
17	No conversion at the expense of customer value.	Mis-selling creates churn and harm.	An aggressive upsell drives early cancellations.	Disqualifies the result as success; runs M45.
18	Authorized principals own consequential decisions.	Hipstraw may recommend beyond its authority but never binds the client.	A distributor asks for territory exclusivity.	Drafts terms only (A21); the named signatory decides.
19	Revocation and withdrawal halt affected activity.	Authority can change mid-case.	A recipient revokes consent mid-campaign.	Stops contact across every agent and channel at once (A57).
20	One owner and one verifiable closure per Mission or Case.	Accountability and audit.	A booking is logged but the visit never happens.	Keeps the Case open; no outcome credit until readback (M56).

> **Operating mode for v0.1.** Every item in this playbook is CANDIDATE. Until an item is LIMITED or QUALIFIED for the context in hand, agents run it only in **Lab** (synthetic worlds), in **Shadow** (observing a real program without effects), or under a **Limited-use** authorization where every effectful Move gets human approval. If nothing at the right maturity fits, escalate to the Market Manager and send a draft Line to Labs.

5 Who decides what

Agents may recommend beyond what they may execute. Authority attaches to a named principal, the current policy version, the item's maturity, scope, spend and recipient. Holding a tool never confers it.

5.1 Decision rights

Decision or effect	Agent	Market Architect	Campaign Manager	Market Manager	Sponsor / principal	Specialist	Ref.
Desk research and hypotheses	Runs	—	—	Reviews	Owns material interpretation	—	A03 · A05
Interviews and consented surveys	Runs approved protocol	Runs	—	Approves sample	—	Research steward approves sensitive methods	A13
Create and dispatch a field Mission	Prepares	Executes	Approves	Approves scope	—	Legal / labour consulted	A28 · A29
Publish a claim or creative	Prepares	—	Requests	—	Brand owner approves	Compliance approves material claims	A23
Launch a capped test inside the approved budget	Executes per mode	—	Decides	Sets envelope	—	—	A25
Spend beyond the approved envelope	Recommends	—	Requests	Requests	Decides	Finance consulted	A49
Discount, credit, guarantee or other Gambit	Models	—	Proposes	Proposes	Named approver per Gambit	Finance and Legal per card	§13
Non-binding partner proposal	Drafts	—	—	Approves sending	—	—	A21

Decision or effect	Agent	Market Architect	Campaign Manager	Market Manager	Sponsor / principal	Specialist	Ref.
Partner agreement or exclusivity	Drafts	—	—	Recommends	Signatory decides	Legal approves	A40
Change the Market Position	Sends Impact Signal	Sends Impact Signal	Sends Impact Signal	Decides in a Review	Informed of material change	—	A01
Change Strategy or market thesis materially	—	—	—	Proposes	Approves	—	A16
Scale release (Gate 4 or 5)	Prepares gate evidence	—	—	Recommends	Investment authority decides	Independent verifier attests	A55
Pause or stop for safety, consent or law	Stops at once	Stops at once	Stops at once	Reviews within 1 business day	Informed	—	A57
Reuse data across clients or for research	—	—	—	Requests	—	Data steward decides	A06
Public results, ratings and benchmarks	Prepares	—	—	—	—	Independent evaluation owner approves	G12

5.2 Execution modes

Each mandate sets one mode per channel and system. A higher mode adds to the one above it.

Mode	What Hipstraw may do
Advisory	Assess, model and recommend. Produces Briefs and Reviews. No external contact.
Instrument	Also drafts offers, proposals, Mission orders and messages for a person to send. Nothing binding.

Mode	What Hipstraw may do
Managed work	Also runs accepted Cases and Missions inside the mandate's caps: contacts consenting participants, schedules, follows up.
Approved effect	Also executes specific effects in host systems (launch a campaign, publish a price test) with per-effect authorization and a receipt.
Faculty mandate	Persistent stewardship of named Market Positions under the same limits. Never signs agreements, never holds customer funds.

5.3 Which manager owns which Position

Managed object	Accountable owner	Boundary
Portfolio Position	Portfolio Market Executive	Allocates across market units. Never infers a portfolio result from one pilot.
Program Position	Program Manager	A finite, chartered engagement. Cannot override consent, partner contracts or Case deadlines.
Market Position (MP1–MP7)	Market Manager	One consolidated, versioned interpretation, changed only by a Market Review.
Partner / channel Position	Partnership Manager	Access, commitments and partner economics. Does not bind all market access.
Campaign or Experiment Case	Campaign Manager	Hypothesis, cohort, treatments, budget, stop rules. Material changes go back to the Market Manager.
Mission or pursuit	Named coordinator or specialist	Bounded work and evidence. May request a Review; never promotes a Position claim.
Methods and qualification	School and Labs	Promote, narrow or retire methods. Separate from any live market decision.

Three levels of discretion. *Task discretion* chooses tools and sequence inside one work order. *Line discretion* picks certified branches and Moves inside one Campaign Case. *Strategic discretion* chooses or proposes Strategies for an owned Market Position. Moving up a level needs the mandate, the item's maturity, evidence and approval.

Part C · Picking the right choice

The quick picker, the compatibility matrices and the situation finder.

6 The quick picker

Eight steps from reality to a verified outcome. Most cases take the defaults in the table below.

1. **Review what changed** (§2.4). Separate observation from interpretation; use the freshest authoritative evidence.
2. **Read the Position** (§2). Name the market unit, the seven axis states and the binding constraint.
3. **Check the blocks** (§4 · §5). Any consent, safety, law, authority, gate or economics stop? If yes, do not proceed with a consequential effect.
4. **Choose the stance** (§7.1). Take the default for the binding constraint; adjust within the allowed set. Prefer the least irreversible commitment.
5. **Choose the Strategy** (§7.2 · §9). Name the buyer behaviour and value you intend to cause, not the activity.
6. **Find the Play and Line** (§8 · §7.4 · §7.7). Match the situation and market type; take the Play's preferred Line for the context.
7. **Check each Move and Action** (§7.5 · §7.6 · §14). Remove any Move the stance rules out; confirm who runs each Action and in which mode.
8. **Verify and learn** (§14, tier 6). Did the intended customer and economic outcome happen in an authoritative source? Record the counterfactual, limits, next Review and disposition.

If in doubt: defaults

Situation	Stance	Strategy	Play	Lines
Market unmapped, need uncertain	Listen	S01 Map the actual market	P01 / P03	L01

Situation	Stance	Strategy	Play	Lines
“Interesting” but nobody takes a next step	Probe	S06 Create a credible first commitment	P02	L02 → L06
Target buyers exist but can’t be reached	Scout	S04 Establish trusted market access	P07 / P13	L04
Offer is hard to explain	Probe	S05 Make the proposition intelligible	P09 / P12	L05
Commitments exist, transactions break	Build	S09 Build a viable transaction	P30	L09
Demand outruns safe supply	Build (Protect if unsafe)	S11 Develop market liquidity	P19 / P22	L11
Growth with falling contribution	Protect / Pause	S12 Protect unit economics	P23 / P31	L12
Next territory or segment proposed	Expand	S15 Expand to adjacent markets	P27 / P28	L15
Consent, law or safety issue	Protect / Pause	S16 Preserve optionality and exit intelligently	P26 / P32	L16
Nothing qualified fits	Listen	Escalate to the Market Manager	—	Send a draft Line to Labs

7 Compatibility matrices

Use these to check that a combination is allowed. ● default · ○ allowed · × never · blank = not typical. A stance marked × on any axis that applies is ruled out for the whole market unit.

7.1 Position state × Stance

Axis · state	Listen	Scout	Probe	Co-create	Activate	Build	Expand	Protect
MP1 Need								
Not mapped	●	○			×	×	×	
Hypothesis	○	○	●	○	×		×	
Supported			○	○	●	○		

Axis · state	Listen	Scout	Probe	Co-create	Activate	Build	Expand	Protect
Contested	○	○	●		×		×	○
Rejected	○				×	×	×	●
MP2 Buyers & access								
Unknown	○	●			×		×	
Reachable	○		●	○				
Engaged			○	○	●			
Converting					○	●	○	
Can't reach	○	●			×		×	○
MP3 Offer								
Concept	○		○	●	×		×	
Prototype			●	○			×	
Tested			○	○	●			
Fits					○	●	○	
Misfits	●		○	○	×		×	○
MP4 Route to market								
Untested		○	●				×	
Piloting			○	○	●		×	
Repeatable					○	○	●	
Saturated		○	●				×	○
Blocked		○			×		×	●
MP5 Delivery system								
Fragile			○	○		●	×	○
Working					○	●	×	
Reliable					○	○	●	
Resilient					○		●	
Broken					×	○	×	●
MP6 Economics								
Not modeled	○		●				×	
Assumed			●		○	○	×	
Observed			○		○	●	○	
Viable					○	○	●	
Negative			○		×	○	×	●
MP7 Repeatability & scale								
First of its kind			○	○	○	●	×	

Axis · state	Listen	Scout	Probe	Co-create	Activate	Build	Expand	Protect
Repeatable			●		○	○	○	
Transferable					○	○	●	
Scaled					○	○	●	
Regressing			○		×	○	×	●

7.2 Strategy × Stance

Strategy	Listen	Scout	Probe	Co-create	Activate	Build	Expand	Protect
S01 Map the actual market	●	○	○		×		×	
S02 Disconfirm a seductive thesis	○	○	●		×		×	
S03 Prioritize a market wedge	○	●	○				×	
S04 Establish trusted market access	○	●	○	○			×	
S05 Make the proposition intelligible	○		●	○	○			
S06 Create a credible first commitment			○	○	●		×	
S07 Recruit market co-builders	○		○	●	○		×	
S08 Unlock channel leverage		○	●	○	○			
S09 Build a viable transaction				○	○	●	×	○
S10 Create repeatable acquisition					●	○	○	○
S11 Develop market liquidity			○		○	●	×	○
S12 Protect unit economics			○			○	×	●
S13 Establish regional legitimacy	○	●	○	○			×	
S14 Compound partnerships and community	○			●	○	○		
S15 Expand to adjacent markets		○	○				●	○
S16 Preserve optionality and exit intelligently	○		○		×		×	●

7.3 Strategy × Play

Strategy	Primary for these Plays	Also used by
S01 Map the actual market	P03 · P06	P01

Strategy	Primary for these Plays	Also used by
S02 Disconfirm a seductive thesis	— (runs inside the Plays at right)	P02 · P03 · P18 · P32
S03 Prioritize a market wedge	P01 · P04 · P10	—
S04 Establish trusted market access	P07	P13 · P16
S05 Make the proposition intelligible	P09 · P12 · P18	P04
S06 Create a credible first commitment	P02 · P14 · P15	P06 · P11 · P12 · P17 · P28
S07 Recruit market co-builders	P11 · P17	P10
S08 Unlock channel leverage	P13 · P21	P29
S09 Build a viable transaction	P20 · P24 · P30	P19
S10 Create repeatable acquisition	P25	P24 · P31
S11 Develop market liquidity	P08 · P19 · P22	—
S12 Protect unit economics	P23 · P31	P15 · P25
S13 Establish regional legitimacy	P05 · P26	P27
S14 Compound partnerships and community	P16 · P29	P14 · P20
S15 Expand to adjacent markets	P27 · P28	—
S16 Preserve optionality and exit intelligently	P32	P21 · P26

7.4 Play × Line

Play	Preferred Lines (context)	Alternatives	Gambits
P01 Territory Prioritization	L01 → L03	L19	—
P02 Need Claim Versus Behavior	L02, then L06	L05	G06
P03 Unmet Job Discovery	L01; L02 once a thesis exists	L17	—
P04 Vertical Wedge Selection	L03 → L05	L07	G02

Play	Preferred Lines (context)	Alternatives	Gambits
P05 Local Context Translation	L13	L17	G07
P06 Trigger and Timing Window	L01 → L06; L06 first if the window is closing	L18	—
P07 Street / Trade Access Bridge	L04	L17	G03 · G07
P08 Two-Sided Seed	L11	L09	G05 · G11
P09 Positioning Comprehension	L05	L18	—
P10 Switching Wedge	L03 → L07	L06	G02 · G10
P11 Design Partner Proof	L07 → L09	L06	G01 · G02
P12 Category Education to Action	L05 → L06	L14	G12
P13 Channel Access Validation	L08	L04	G04 · G08
P14 Live Demand Event	L06 (the event is the test)	L14	G03
P15 Trial-to-Paid Conversion	L05 to reframe; L06 to probe price	L12	G02 · G06
P16 Community Trust Loop	L14	L04	G03 · G08
P17 Consensus and Buying Roles	L07	L05	G02
P18 Offer Fit Reframe	L05	L02	G06
P19 Supply / Delivery Balancing	L11 → L09	L12	G05 · G09
P20 Trust-and-Quality Assurance	L09	L20	G10
P21 Partner Economics and Governance	L08	L16	G04 · G07 · G08
P22 Supply Activation	L11	L17	G05 · G11
P23 Margin Integrity	L12	L16	—
P24 Activation Reliability	L09	L20	G01 · G09

Play	Preferred Lines (context)	Alternatives	Gambits
P25 Channel Saturation and Renewal	L10	L18	—
P26 Permission and Compliance Review	L13 steps 1–2 when entering; L16 when an activity is in breach	L17	—
P27 Geography Transfer	L15	L13	—
P28 Adjacency Validation	L03 → L06	L07	—
P29 Creator / Community Fit	L14	L18	G03
P30 First Market System Build	L09	L11	G01 · G09
P31 Scale System Repair	L12 → L15	L20	—
P32 Pause, Reframe or Retire	L16	L02	—

7.5 Line × Move

Line	Steps in order (Moves and Actions)	Branch steps
L01 Territory Reconnaissance	A01 → M05 → M06 → M07 → M15 → A05	L04 · P26
L02 Disconfirming Discovery	A05 → M03 → M02 → M10 → A05	L16 · A15
L03 Wedge Selection	M09 → A10 → M14 → A15 → A16	M13 · L04
L04 Access Bridge	M07 → M18 → A19 → M19 → M20	L17 · A57
L05 Message and Offer Probe	M25 → A23 → M22 → M23 → A24	M29 · L02
L06 Behavioral Test	A11 → M40 → A25 → M10 → A12 → A47	M33 · G06 · L02
L07 Design Partner Loop	M37 → A40 → M17 → M28 → A30 → M56 → A15	M24 · G02
L08 Channel Validation	M20 → M21 → M42 → A25 → A20 → M47	G04 · G07 · L04

Line	Steps in order (Moves and Actions)	Branch steps
L09 First Transaction Build	M38 → M36 → A38 → A39 → M43 → M56	M55 · L12 · G09
L10 Repeatable Acquisition	A25 → A31 → M46 → M47 → M45 → A47	A43 · L09 · M48
L11 Supply–Demand Balance	A08 → M38 → M39 → M40 → A42 → A44	A43 · G05 · G11 · L12
L12 Margin and Payback Gate	M43 → M47 → M44 → A46 → A16	A43 · L16
L13 Localized Entry	M07 → A22 → M08 → M51 → L17 → A01	M17 · L16
L14 Community and Partner Loop	M01 → M21 → M27 → M34 → M10 → M45	M55 · G03
L15 Transfer and Scale	M50 → A51 → M51 → M46 → M43 → M53 → A55	M49 · L16
L16 Reframe or Stop	A56 → M55 → A57 → M54 → A60	M55 first if harm is live
L17 Human Field Mission	A28 → A29 → M19 / M08 / M01 → A02 → A04 → A60	A57 · quarantine
L18 Campaign as Experiment	A15 → A23 → A49 → A25 → A31 → M56 → A47	M55
L19 Pioneer Portfolio Review	A01 → M14 → A15 → A16 → A49	narrow test
L20 Post-Launch Reliability Pursuit	A12 → A31 → M45 → M49 → A50 → M56 → A60	reopen · A57

7.6 Gambit × Stance

The stance for every Move is on its row in §12.

Gambit	Listen	Scout	Probe	Co-create	Activate	Build	Expand	Protect
G01 Concierge service for learning	×	×	○	○		●	×	×
G02 Paid design partner discount	×	×		●	○			×
G03 Local community seed grant	×	×	○	●				×
G04 Limited reseller incentive	×	×	○		●		○	×
G05 Supply readiness guarantee	×	×			○	●		×

Gambit	Listen	Scout	Probe	Co-create	Activate	Build	Expand	Protect
G06 Introductory price staircase	×	×	○		●		×	×
G07 One-neighborhood exclusivity	×	×	×	●	○	○		×
G08 Partner co-marketing investment	×	×		○	●		○	×
G09 Manual service bridge	×	×		○		●	×	×
G10 Beta guarantee / risk reversal	×	×			●	○	○	×
G11 Micro-market subsidy	×	×	○			●	×	×
G12 Open research / public benchmark	×	×		●		○	○	×

7.7 Market type × Play

The market type predicts where the first win usually is and the typical trap.

Market type	Market reality	Priority Plays	Typical trap
AR01 Unserved demand pocket	Need exists but access, recognition or affordability fails	P03 · P07 · P13 · P20	A small visible sample does not represent the region
AR02 New category / behaviour	The need must be named, understood and normalized	P02 · P12 · P14	Curiosity mistaken for adoption
AR03 Mature market displacement	Customers already buy substitutes	P10 · P15 · P17	Switching cost underestimated
AR04 Horizontal product → vertical niche	A generic product does not feel industry-specific	P04 · P11 · P18	Custom solution that cannot repeat
AR05 Regional or cross-border entry	Context and institutions differ	P05 · P13 · P21 · P27	Localization and legal mismatch
AR06 Product adjacency expansion	An existing base suggests new jobs or buyers	P04 · P10 · P28	Existing customers assumed to want the adjacency
AR07 Two-sided or multi-sided market	Demand depends on complementary supply	P08 · P19 · P22	One-sided subsidy hides weak liquidity

Market type	Market reality	Priority Plays	Typical trap
AR08 Fragmented local services	Scattered providers, low trust, uneven quality	P07 · P19 · P20	Provider verification and safety
AR09 Creator / community-led niche	Trust and identity drive discovery	P12 · P16 · P29	Extractive participation or false advocacy
AR10 Enterprise design-partner market	Complex roles and integration needs	P11 · P17 · P24	No economic buyer; hidden technical friction
AR11 Channel-led / embedded distribution	Another principal owns access and attention	P13 · P21 · P24	Partner dependence and weak attribution
AR12 Distressed or disrupted market	A shock changes choices quickly	P01 · P06 · P32	Exploiting the crisis or acting on stale conditions
AR13 Supply-constrained market	Interest exists; fulfillment lags	P19 · P22 · P23	Generating demand that harms customers
AR14 Public / institutional ecosystem	Regulation and procurement dominate	P05 · P21 · P26	Procurement and legal failure
AR15 Micro-market / neighborhood	Dense local behavioural clusters	P03 · P07 · P13 · P20	One street taken for the city
AR16 Reactivation / second-life market	Past users went dormant	P02 · P15 · P18	Wrong churn theory; nuisance outreach

8 Situation finder

Find what you see, then go to the Play and its first step. The axis column says which Position the signal mainly speaks to.

What you see	Play	First step	Axis
Need and buyers			
Many claim the need; none take a next step	P02 Need Claim Versus Behavior	M10 Behavioral Commitment Test	MP1
Interviewees contradict the desk thesis	P02 Need Claim Versus Behavior	M03 Disconfirming Probe	MP1

What you see	Play	First step	Axis
Customer workarounds are visible	P03 Unmet Job Discovery	M01 Contextual Observation	MP1
A sudden event creates interest	P06 Trigger and Timing Window	M12 Trigger Verification	MP1
The market looks large but the audience is diffuse	P01 Territory Prioritization	M06 Audience Source Mapping	MP2
The same product attracts unrelated segments	P04 Vertical Wedge Selection	M09 Archetype Segmentation	MP2
Regional customer language differs	P05 Local Context Translation	M08 Local Interpreter Mission	MP2
Stores or partners refuse access	P07 Street / Trade Access Bridge	M18 Trusted Introduction	MP2
The pipeline stalls on committee decisions	P17 Consensus and Buying Roles	M24 Buying Committee Map	MP2
Offer and conversion			
The offer is too hard to explain	P09 Positioning Comprehension	M22 Proposition Comprehension Test	MP3
Incumbent's customers are dissatisfied but stay	P10 Switching Wedge	M15 Alternative Mapping	MP3
Enterprise buyer cannot see the ROI	P11 Design Partner Proof	M28 Outcome Prototype	MP3
Educational content is admired but unused	P12 Category Education to Action	M10 Behavioral Commitment Test	MP3
Trial users do not pay	P15 Trial-to-Paid Conversion	M33 Price / Value Exchange Probe	MP3
The same objection recurs across qualified prospects	P18 Offer Fit Reframe	M29 Objection Taxonomy	MP3
Strong sign-ups, no activation	P24 Activation Reliability	M30 Friction Observation	MP3
Existing buyers ask for an adjacent use case	P28 Adjacency Validation	M13 Adjacent Job Probe	MP7
Channels and partners			

What you see	Play	First step	Axis
Resellers promise distribution but deliver no access	P13 Channel Access Validation	M20 Channel Qualification Audit	MP4
A partner introduces many unqualified leads	P13 Channel Access Validation	M20 Channel Qualification Audit	MP4
A local event draws a crowd but few buyers	P14 Live Demand Event	M35 Post-Event Qualification	MP4
Influencer traffic is large but not qualified	P29 Creator / Community Fit	M26 Creator Audience Fit Test	MP4
A channel partner asks for an exclusive territory	P21 Partner Economics and Governance	M42 Nonexclusive Channel Test	MP4
Growing spend brings declining returns	P25 Channel Saturation and Renewal	M47 Marginal Return Test	MP4
The community pays attention but won't transact	P16 Community Trust Loop	M27 Authentic Partner Mission	MP2
Supply and delivery			
Supply and demand each wait for the other	P08 Two-Sided Seed	M39 Liquidity Seeding	MP5
High demand, unreliable providers	P19 Supply / Delivery Balancing	M40 Capacity / Service Reliability Gate	MP5
Bookings fail for lack of supply	P22 Supply Activation	M38 Provider Readiness Audit	MP5
People fear local-service quality	P20 Trust-and-Quality Assurance	M41 Assured Pilot	MP5
Fast acquisition, severe early churn	P20 Trust-and-Quality Assurance	M45 Retention / Trust Diagnosis	MP5
High-value accounts need a hand-built solution	P30 First Market System Build	M36 Manual Fulfillment Proof	MP5
Economics and scale			
Conversions inflated by incentives; CAC masked by promotions	P23 Margin Integrity	M43 True Contribution Rebuild	MP6

What you see	Play	First step	Axis
The market repeats but margin deteriorates	P31 Scale System Repair	M43 True Contribution Rebuild	MP6
One city strong, the next one collapses	P27 Geography Transfer	M50 Transferability Test	MP7
Conduct and compliance			
The user group requires regulated acquisition	P26 Permission and Compliance Review	Legal review A22 (M55 if the activity is live)	All
Sensitive audience or unsafe practice	P26 Permission and Compliance Review	M55 Pause / Remediate Intervention	All
The hypothesis keeps failing or the environment changed	P32 Pause, Reframe or Retire	M54 Pivot Hypothesis Draft (M55 if harm is live)	MP1

Part D · The catalogue

Every Strategy, Play, Line, Move, Gambit and Action. IDs follow the workbook; all items are CANDIDATE.

9 Strategies

Strategies describe outcomes, not tone. The live Strategy is chosen for one market unit and its Position. A Strategy can keep running while the stance changes as evidence develops.

S01 · Map the actual market

Find out who has the problem and how the market works today.

- **Use when:** the segment, actors or substitutes are uncertain; MP1 is Not mapped or MP2 is Unknown. **Don't use when:** a credible market and decision unit are already mapped.
- **Must be true:** an explicit scope, named observation sources, and room for contradictory cases.
- **Stance:** Listen (default) · allowed Scout, Probe · never Activate, Expand.
- **Plays:** P03, P06 · also P01. **Lines:** L01. **Levers:** need clarity, access.
- **Who decides:** Research Lead runs it; the sponsor approves the market boundary.

- **Done when:** an actor-and-job map exists with known, unknown and source limits stated.
- **Example:** ten buyers and two supply intermediaries interviewed in one B2B SaaS vertical before any campaign.
- **Pioneer's tip:** map the substitute first. What people do today is the market you are entering.

S02 · Disconfirm a seductive thesis

Find the fastest evidence that the opportunity is wrong.

- **Use when:** confidence comes from anecdote or founder conviction; MP1 is Hypothesis or Contested. **Don't use when:** a stop deadline makes more sampling harmful.
- **Must be true:** named rival hypotheses and a disconfirming protocol.
- **Stance:** Probe (default) · allowed Listen, Scout · never Activate, Expand.
- **Plays:** runs inside P02, P03, P18, P32. **Lines:** L02. **Levers:** need clarity, problem intensity.
- **Who decides:** Research steward runs it; the sponsor owns the stop.
- **Done when:** the thesis is narrowed, rejected, or survives a genuine test.
- **Example:** interview buyers who chose to stay with the incumbent last quarter.
- **Pioneer's tip:** write the falsifier before the first interview, or you will move the goalposts.

S03 · Prioritize a market wedge

Pick one narrow, reachable, valuable first market.

- **Use when:** a broad TAM meets scarce capacity. **Don't use when:** the wedge would sacrifice a proven strategic obligation.
- **Must be true:** an archetype map, reach, need, rough economics and comparative cost to learn.
- **Stance:** Scout (default) · allowed Listen, Probe · never Expand.
- **Plays:** P01, P04, P10. **Lines:** L03. **Levers:** need clarity, access, optionality.
- **Who decides:** Market Manager with the sponsor.
- **Done when:** one testable market unit is chosen, with a bounded second-best alternative.
- **Example:** start with 50 specialty logistics operators rather than "all SMBs".
- **Pioneer's tip:** rank wedges by the value of the decision they unlock, not by TAM.

S04 · Establish trusted market access

Earn permission and trust to reach the right buyers.

- **Use when:** buyers sit behind intermediaries, local gatekeepers or low trust; MP2 is Unknown or Can't reach. **Don't use when:** access would require deception or unlawful contact.
- **Must be true:** permission basis, channel evidence, a gatekeeper map and a reciprocal benefit.
- **Stance:** Scout (default) · allowed Listen, Probe, Co-create · never Expand.
- **Plays:** P07 · also P13, P16. **Lines:** L04, L17. **Levers:** access, trust and credibility.
- **Who decides:** business development owner; Market Manager approves Missions.
- **Done when:** qualified, consenting conversations or introductions happen.
- **Example:** a retired salon-equipment technician joins as a paid local Market Architect.
- **Pioneer's tip:** give the gatekeeper something useful first. An introduction is a favour, not a lead.

S05 · Make the proposition intelligible

Turn a latent job into accurate, compelling language.

- **Use when:** interest is real but understanding is poor; MP3 is Concept or Prototype. **Don't use when:** the claim cannot be substantiated.
- **Must be true:** user vocabulary, a substitute comparison, a comprehension test.
- **Stance:** Probe (default) · allowed Listen, Co-create, Activate.
- **Plays:** P09, P12, P18 · also P04. **Lines:** L05. **Levers:** attention and education, offer and differentiation.
- **Who decides:** brand or product sponsor approves every claim.
- **Done when:** target users can restate what changes for them and why.
- **Example:** replace "AI-first vertical platform" with "closes month-end exceptions in a day, not a week".
- **Pioneer's tip:** test whether people can explain it back, not whether they like it.

S06 · Create a credible first commitment

Turn interest into meaningful, low-friction behaviour.

- **Use when:** qualified attention exists without evidence of real demand. **Don't use when:** delivery is unsafe or the offer terms are unsupported.
- **Must be true:** a valid offer, the buyer role, real capacity and consent.
- **Stance:** Activate (default) · allowed Probe, Co-create · never Expand.
- **Plays:** P02, P14, P15 · also P06, P11, P12, P17, P28. **Lines:** L06. **Levers:** trial and adoption friction, price.
- **Who decides:** the commercial principal approves incentive and spend.

- **Done when:** a deposit, booked appointment, real trial use or paid pilot is verified.
- **Example:** ask for a paid design-partner slot, not another follow-up call.
- **Pioneer's tip:** the commitment must cost the buyer something they value: money, data, time or reputation.

S07 · Recruit market co-builders

Create value with a small set of committed partners.

- **Use when:** the product needs situated co-design. **Don't use when:** participants lack consent or would receive no fair value.
- **Must be true:** a sponsor on each side, design-partner terms, expected mutual contribution.
- **Stance:** Co-create (default) · allowed Listen, Probe, Activate · never Expand.
- **Plays:** P11, P17 · also P10. **Lines:** L07. **Levers:** value delivery, trust.
- **Who decides:** product sponsor and partnership owner.
- **Done when:** partners use it for real and supply evaluated outcome evidence.
- **Example:** two RevOps teams co-design an exception workflow and run it on live data.
- **Pioneer's tip:** two partners who pay beat ten who advise.

S08 · Unlock channel leverage

Get productive third-party access without a dependency trap.

- **Use when:** trusted distributors, associations or platforms reach the target audience. **Don't use when:** the partner offers only vanity introductions.
- **Must be true:** evidence of the partner's ability, economics, conflicts and access permissions.
- **Stance:** Probe (default) · allowed Scout, Co-create, Activate.
- **Plays:** P13, P21 · also P29. **Lines:** L08. **Levers:** channel productivity, partnership and ecosystem.
- **Who decides:** partnership lead; the signatory approves any terms.
- **Done when:** a partner-sourced cohort converts and retains with viable economics.
- **Example:** test one trade association before signing a national agreement.
- **Pioneer's tip:** count activated buyers per partner, never introductions.

S09 · Build a viable transaction

Make trial, fulfillment, payment and support work together.

- **Use when:** demand exists but value delivery is uncertain; MP5 is Fragile or Working. **Don't use when:** safety, assurance or economics prohibit launch.
- **Must be true:** real service and support capacity; legal review where needed.
- **Stance:** Build (default) · allowed Co-create, Activate, Protect · never Expand.
- **Plays:** P20, P24, P30 · also P19. **Lines:** L09. **Levers:** value delivery, supply and liquidity.
- **Who decides:** the principal's operating owner.
- **Done when:** end-to-end transactions settle with verified customer value (Gate 2).
- **Example:** book and fulfil one appliance repair with a verified technician, payment and follow-up.
- **Pioneer's tip:** do it by hand first. Automate only the steps that worked.

S10 · Create repeatable acquisition

Develop a predictable, responsible market-entry motion.

- **Use when:** two pilot cohorts succeeded with stable supply. **Don't use when:** acquisition economics are negative or trust is declining.
- **Must be true:** a segmented funnel, incremental costs and cohort data.
- **Stance:** Activate (default) · allowed Build, Expand, Protect.
- **Plays:** P25 · also P24, P31. **Lines:** L10. **Levers:** channel productivity, retention and referrals.
- **Who decides:** growth owner with a finance partner.
- **Done when:** incremental new customers convert at sustainable contribution (Gate 3).
- **Example:** repeat the same niche offer to a second, independently recruited cohort.
- **Pioneer's tip:** freeze the cohort definition before you look at results.

S11 · Develop market liquidity

Increase effective matching on every side of the market.

- **Use when:** a supply–demand cold start. **Don't use when:** subsidy would mask permanently negative economics.
- **Must be true:** two-sided capacity, fulfillment and participation incentives.
- **Stance:** Build (default) · allowed Probe, Activate, Protect · never Expand.
- **Plays:** P08, P19, P22. **Lines:** L11. **Levers:** supply and liquidity.
- **Who decides:** marketplace owner.
- **Done when:** match time, fill rate and repeat use meet the stated gates.
- **Example:** recruit five reliable local providers before promoting 200 bookings.
- **Pioneer's tip:** supply first, then demand, in that order, every time.

S12 · Protect unit economics

Stop expansion that destroys value.

- **Use when:** growth and incentives conceal costs; MP6 is Negative or MP7 is Regressing. **Don't use when:** there is no reliable cost or fulfillment attribution yet (model it first).
- **Must be true:** direct and allocated cost, refunds, discounts and marginal CAC.
- **Stance:** Protect (default) · allowed Probe, Build · never Expand.
- **Plays:** P23, P31 · also P15, P25. **Lines:** L12. **Levers:** price and unit economics.
- **Who decides:** finance or economic sponsor.
- **Done when:** net incremental contribution and cash use are defensible.
- **Example:** stop a city launch after delivery overruns exceed margin.
- **Pioneer's tip:** include refunds, creator commissions and human hours, or the margin is fiction.

S13 · Establish regional legitimacy

Adapt route, offer and operations to a real place.

- **Use when:** entry crosses a language, norm or policy boundary. **Don't use when:** localization would rely on cultural stereotypes.
- **Must be true:** local research, counsel, partners and field evidence.
- **Stance:** Scout (default) · allowed Listen, Probe, Co-create · never Expand.
- **Plays:** P05, P26 · also P27. **Lines:** L13. **Levers:** trust and credibility, partnership.
- **Who decides:** regional owner.
- **Done when:** local participants validate relevance, fulfillment and trust.
- **Example:** partner with bilingual neighborhood organizers in Bengaluru.
- **Pioneer's tip:** a region is not a unit of proof. Each country, city or segment earns its own Position.

S14 · Compound partnerships and community

Make mutually valuable relationships durable.

- **Use when:** trust and repeat participation drive adoption. **Don't use when:** engagement would be extractive.
- **Must be true:** a benefit allocation, disclosures, partner expectations.
- **Stance:** Co-create (default) · allowed Listen, Activate, Build.
- **Plays:** P16, P29 · also P14, P20. **Lines:** L14. **Levers:** partnership and ecosystem, retention and referrals.
- **Who decides:** partner or community steward.

- **Done when:** retention, referrals and partner economics persist.
- **Example:** a community event that gives useful, independent education.
- **Pioneer's tip:** if the community would not invite you back, it was a campaign, not a relationship.

S15 · Expand to adjacent markets

Transfer a validated pattern to a new segment, context or geography.

- **Use when:** the core niche has proven economics (Gate 3). **Don't use when:** transfer assumptions are untested or the core is deteriorating.
- **Must be true:** new-market holdouts, supply, unit economics and compliance.
- **Stance:** Expand (default) · allowed Scout, Probe, Protect.
- **Plays:** P27, P28. **Lines:** L15. **Levers:** optionality, channel productivity.
- **Who decides:** market portfolio sponsor.
- **Done when:** the new segment passes its own evaluation gate (Gate 4).
- **Example:** test a nearby vertical before opening three countries.
- **Pioneer's tip:** treat every new territory as a new experiment with its own stop rule.

S16 · Preserve optionality and exit intelligently

Avoid sunk-cost escalation; park, pivot or retire weak options.

- **Use when:** costs rise faster than learning, or the thesis is invalidated. **Don't use when:** waiting would expose people to harm or create binding obligations.
- **Must be true:** a decision cutoff, salvageable assets, an alternate thesis and a transition plan.
- **Stance:** Protect (default) · allowed Listen, Probe · never Activate, Expand.
- **Plays:** P32 · also P21, P26. **Lines:** L16. **Levers:** optionality.
- **Who decides:** sponsor or investment authority.
- **Done when:** spend stops or is reallocated, participants are protected and learning is kept.
- **Example:** retire paid acquisition in a failed micro-market but keep the research.
- **Pioneer's tip:** a well-documented stop is a result. Count it in the Quarterly Review.

10 Plays

A Play is a recognized market situation and its response family, not a fixed automation. Each Play can run several Lines depending on authority, stage, market type and evidence. Plays are grouped by the discipline where they usually start.

Explore

P01 · Territory Prioritization

Choose a small territory from broad plausible demand.

- **Use when:** many industries or regions compete for attention. **Don't use when:** segment economics and access are not comparable.
- **Must be true:** a territory map, jobs, feasible reach, substitutes, stated uncertainties.
- **Stance:** Scout (default) · Listen, Probe · never Activate, Expand. **Strategy:** S03 (also S01).
- **Lines:** L01 → L03 · alt. L19. **First step:** M06 Audience Source Mapping.
- **Who decides:** Market Manager with the sponsor. **Done when:** a ranked wedge, excluded alternatives and a testable reason.
- **Example:** compare Series B SaaS RevOps teams against "all software firms". **Tip:** write down why the losers lost; you will revisit them.

P02 · Need Claim Versus Behavior

Separate reported interest from costly behaviour.

- **Use when:** polite interviews or content enthusiasm. **Don't use when:** the user has no realistic way to act yet.
- **Must be true:** the buyer job, a compliant trial or commitment, realistic alternatives.
- **Stance:** Probe (default) · Listen, Activate · never Expand. **Strategy:** S06 (also S02).
- **Lines:** L02, then L06 · alt. L05. **Gambits:** G06. **First step:** M10 Behavioral Commitment Test.
- **Who decides:** Research Lead. **Done when:** at least one real action threshold is tested and negative cases are interpreted.
- **Example:** after a positive concept review, ask for a live trial on the buyer's own data. **Tip:** report the denominator. "3 of 40 said yes", never "3 said yes".

P03 · Unmet Job Discovery

Reveal workarounds and persistent jobs nobody serves well.

- **Use when:** repeated manual improvisation is visible. **Don't use when:** research would expose confidential or intimate data.
- **Must be true:** consent, site context, independent observations.
- **Stance:** Listen (default) · Scout · never Activate, Expand. **Strategy:** S01 (also S02).
- **Lines:** L01; L02 once a thesis exists · alt. L17. **First step:** M01 Contextual Observation.

- **Who decides:** field Research Lead. **Done when:** problem mechanisms and willingness-to-change constraints are understood.
- **Example:** observe independent caterers reconciling fragmented lunch orders. **Tip:** cost the workaround in hours or money; that is your price ceiling.

P05 · Local Context Translation

Stop assumptions travelling unchanged across places.

- **Use when:** a global offer meets an unfamiliar context. **Don't use when:** law or safe field access cannot be supported.
- **Must be true:** local language and trade structure; counsel where material.
- **Stance:** Scout (default) · Listen, Co-create · never Expand. **Strategy:** S13.
- **Lines:** L13 · alt. L17. **Gambits:** G07. **First step:** M08 Local Interpreter Mission.
- **Who decides:** regional owner. **Done when:** the local proposition and delivery format survive a field test.
- **Example:** adapt booking, payment and support formats for one Indian city. **Tip:** translate the buying process, not just the words.

P06 · Trigger and Timing Window

Act on an authentic event that opens a limited window.

- **Use when:** a regulatory, technical or financial trigger shifts urgency. **Don't use when:** the event is speculative or targeting it would exploit people.
- **Must be true:** a source-confirmed event, affected parties and a cutoff date.
- **Stance:** Scout (default) · Probe, Activate · never Expand. **Strategy:** S01 (also S06).
- **Lines:** L01 → L06; L06 first if the window is closing · alt. L18. **First step:** M12 Trigger Verification.
- **Who decides:** research and compliance sponsor. **Done when:** a useful decision is made before the window closes.
- **Example:** a new procurement rule opens demand for evidence software. **Tip:** deadlines come first; a quick, honest test beats a perfect late one.

P07 · Street / Trade Access Bridge

Gain lawful local access to fragmented buyers and sellers.

- **Use when:** phone lists and ads cannot reach small operators. **Don't use when:** ambassadors would pressure people or misrepresent who they work for.
- **Must be true:** permitted venues, voluntary introductions, a credible local partner.
- **Stance:** Scout (default) · Listen, Co-create · never Activate, Expand. **Strategy:** S04.

- **Lines:** L04 · alt. L17. **Gambits:** G03, G07. **First step:** M18 Trusted Introduction.
- **Who decides:** local Market Architect manager. **Done when:** verified permitted interviews, sample quality and a feasible channel.
- **Example:** map 25 salon owners across two neighborhoods. **Tip:** log refusals as carefully as yeses; they define the reachable market.

Develop

P04 · Vertical Wedge Selection

Make one segment's offer more precise than a generic pitch.

- **Use when:** several markets express generic demand. **Don't use when:** no segment-specific difference survives testing.
- **Must be true:** buyer archetypes, workflow economics, vertical language.
- **Stance:** Probe (default) · Scout, Co-create · never Expand. **Strategy:** S03 (also S05).
- **Lines:** L03 → L05 · alt. L07. **Gambits:** G02. **First step:** M09 Archetype Segmentation.
- **Who decides:** product / market sponsor. **Done when:** a vertical offer is chosen and one segment engages meaningfully.
- **Example:** a contract-review tool positioned for healthcare staffing teams. **Tip:** a vertical is real when buyers use their own jargon back to you.

P09 · Positioning Comprehension

Fix a value proposition nobody can restate.

- **Use when:** awareness is high but understanding is low. **Don't use when:** simplifying would hide material terms.
- **Must be true:** original customer language and comparator claims.
- **Stance:** Probe (default) · Listen, Co-create. **Strategy:** S05.
- **Lines:** L05 · alt. L18. **First step:** M22 Proposition Comprehension Test.
- **Who decides:** brand owner. **Done when:** the target audience explains who, what, when and why correctly.
- **Example:** test "AI vendor discovery" against "saves 6 hours a week of supplier research". **Tip:** if a buyer cannot repeat it to their boss, it does not exist.

P10 · Switching Wedge

Find a defensible advantage against a habitual incumbent.

- **Use when:** satisfied category users rarely switch. **Don't use when:** there is no credible advantage.

- **Must be true:** substitutes, switching cost, pilot safety.
- **Stance:** Probe (default) · Co-create, Activate · never Expand. **Strategy:** S03 (also S07).
- **Lines:** L03 → L07 · alt. L06. **Gambits:** G02, G10. **First step:** M15 Alternative Mapping.
- **Who decides:** product sponsor. **Done when:** specific switchers commit for a reason that survives objection.
- **Example:** pilot alongside the incumbent first, displace later. **Tip:** measure the switching cost honestly with M16 before you price.

P11 · Design Partner Proof

Build evidence for complex enterprise adoption.

- **Use when:** the buyer wants proof inside its own processes. **Don't use when:** the partner has no staff or economic decision access.
- **Must be true:** a pilot charter, a sponsor, security clearance and a measurable success test.
- **Stance:** Co-create (default) · Probe · never Expand. **Strategy:** S07 (also S06).
- **Lines:** L07 → L09 · alt. L06. **Gambits:** G01, G02. **First step:** M28 Outcome Prototype.
- **Who decides:** enterprise sponsor. **Done when:** adoption is evaluated and the joint next decision is recorded.
- **Example:** run one real workflow with an executive and an operator. **Tip:** agree the success metric and the stop date in the charter, not at week 6.

P12 · Category Education to Action

Turn an unfamiliar capability into action and value.

- **Use when:** users understand the old alternatives but not the new category. **Don't use when:** the "education" is branded propaganda posing as research.
- **Must be true:** an accurate explanation, unbiased alternatives, permitted content.
- **Stance:** Probe (default) · Co-create, Activate. **Strategy:** S05 (also S06).
- **Lines:** L05 → L06 · alt. L14. **Gambits:** G12. **First step:** M10 Behavioral Commitment Test.
- **Who decides:** market education steward. **Done when:** comprehension and voluntary meaningful action both improve.
- **Example:** a workshop on agent-assisted local supply services, ending in an optional pilot sign-up. **Tip:** end every lesson with one small, real action.

P13 · Channel Access Validation

Test whether an intermediary can deliver qualified demand.

- **Use when:** a reseller promises reach or platform placement. **Don't use when:** exclusivity is demanded before proof.
- **Must be true:** partner referrals, economics, observed activation, disclosure.
- **Stance:** Probe (default) · Scout, Co-create · never Expand. **Strategy:** S08 (also S04).
- **Lines:** L08 · alt. L04. **Gambits:** G04, G08. **First step:** M20 Channel Qualification Audit.
- **Who decides:** partner owner. **Done when:** net qualified, activated users justify the route.
- **Example:** test one embedded workflow with association members. **Tip:** ask for 20 named, consenting introductions before discussing a revenue share.

P14 · Live Demand Event

Turn an event into measurable learning, not crowd size.

- **Use when:** a demonstration explains the offer better than a page. **Don't use when:** safety, venue or permission requirements are missing.
- **Must be true:** an invited segment, event consent, a follow-up design and a cost cap.
- **Stance:** Activate (default) · Probe, Co-create. **Strategy:** S06 (also S14).
- **Lines:** L06 · alt. L14. **Gambits:** G03. **First step:** M35 Post-Event Qualification.
- **Who decides:** event lead. **Done when:** participant learning and downstream action are documented.
- **Example:** a pop-up demonstration at a trade centre. **Tip:** decide the follow-up ask before the venue.

P15 · Trial-to-Paid Conversion

Find out whether the trial earns a buying decision.

- **Use when:** usage shows value but checkout or pricing fails. **Don't use when:** the trial did not actually deliver the benefit.
- **Must be true:** usage by role, objection evidence, true price and alternatives.
- **Stance:** Probe (default) · Activate · never Expand. **Strategy:** S06 (also S12).
- **Lines:** L05 to reframe; L06 to probe price · alt. L12. **Gambits:** G02, G06. **First step:** M33 Price / Value Exchange Probe.
- **Who decides:** growth or product owner. **Done when:** real paid conversions with acceptable churn and margin.
- **Example:** test a paid pilot fee against a permanent free tier. **Tip:** check M32 first; a hollow trial makes every price look wrong.

P16 · Community Trust Loop

Earn belonging and referral without manipulation.

- **Use when:** local or professional relationships shape purchase. **Don't use when:** paid influence would be undisclosed or vulnerable people targeted.
- **Must be true:** community needs, a transparent benefit, room for independent critique.
- **Stance:** Co-create (default) · Listen · never Expand. **Strategy:** S14 (also S04).
- **Lines:** L14 · alt. L04. **Gambits:** G03, G08. **First step:** M27 Authentic Partner Mission.
- **Who decides:** community steward. **Done when:** repeated authentic interactions and verified useful referrals.
- **Example:** a professional circle hosts peer learning with no forced promotion. **Tip:** let members criticize you in public; it is what makes the praise believable.

P17 · Consensus and Buying Roles

Map objections across economic, technical and user stakeholders.

- **Use when:** the champion cannot progress without a committee. **Don't use when:** procurement is missing or authority would be misrepresented.
- **Must be true:** a decision-rights map and agreed evaluation objectives.
- **Stance:** Co-create (default) · Listen, Probe. **Strategy:** S07 (also S06).
- **Lines:** L07 · alt. L05. **Gambits:** G02. **First step:** M24 Buying Committee Map.
- **Who decides:** enterprise field lead. **Done when:** the actual committee endorses a next step.
- **Example:** security, finance and end-user sign-off for a limited pilot. **Tip:** find the person who can say no, then ask what would make it a yes.

P18 · Offer Fit Reframe

Change a mismatched offer based on patterned evidence.

- **Use when:** the same valid objection recurs across 3+ qualified prospects. **Don't use when:** feedback comes from non-targets or is a sales artifact.
- **Must be true:** segment cohorts, an objection taxonomy, feasibility and margin.
- **Stance:** Listen (default) · Probe, Co-create · never Activate, Expand. **Strategy:** S05 (also S02).
- **Lines:** L05 · alt. L02. **Gambits:** G06. **First step:** M29 Objection Taxonomy.
- **Who decides:** product and marketing leads. **Done when:** the modified offer produces better paid behaviour than the prior version.
- **Example:** cut onboarding complexity instead of discounting. **Tip:** not every objection is about price; discounting a misfit offer just loses money faster.

P21 · Partner Economics and Governance

Make a partner exchange viable and bounded.

- **Use when:** a distribution partner demands uncertain commitments. **Don't use when:** decision rights are missing or there is a competition-law issue.
- **Must be true:** a commercial forecast, alternatives, an exit, counsel.
- **Stance:** Co-create (default) · Probe, Expand. **Strategy:** S08 (also S16).
- **Lines:** L08 · alt. L16. **Gambits:** G04, G07, G08. **First step:** M42 Nonexclusive Channel Test.
- **Who decides:** partner signatory. **Done when:** terms are agreed and cohort returns are tracked with no dependency trap.
- **Example:** start non-exclusive before granting any territory protection. **Tip:** exclusivity is a Gambit (G07), never a default term.

P29 · Creator / Community Fit

Check whether reach turns into relevant, trusted action.

- **Use when:** an influencer claims to reach ideal customers. **Don't use when:** disclosure or identity / cultural fit is unresolved.
- **Must be true:** a consented audience signal, rates, cohorts.
- **Stance:** Probe (default) · Co-create · never Expand. **Strategy:** S14 (also S08).
- **Lines:** L14 · alt. L18. **Gambits:** G03. **First step:** M26 Creator Audience Fit Test.
- **Who decides:** community or creator lead. **Done when:** the audience activates in an attributable, credible cohort.
- **Example:** a local home-chef creator gains real recurring subscribers. **Tip:** buy one post with a unique code before buying a series.

Build

P08 · Two-Sided Seed

Create early liquidity without unbounded subsidy.

- **Use when:** sellers wait for users while users wait for supply. **Don't use when:** quality, safety or capacity is too weak.
- **Must be true:** behavioural signals on both sides; economic and fill-rate assumptions.
- **Stance:** Build (default) · Probe, Co-create · never Expand. **Strategy:** S11.
- **Lines:** L11 · alt. L09. **Gambits:** G05, G11. **First step:** M39 Liquidity Seeding.
- **Who decides:** marketplace sponsor. **Done when:** matched transactions complete with repeat intent and controlled cost.
- **Example:** seed reliable tyre-service providers before paid demand. **Tip:** seed one dense micro-market, not a thin city.

P19 · Supply / Delivery Balancing

Stop demand generation from breaking service.

- **Use when:** wait times, cancellations or quality flags rise. **Don't use when:** supply-side safety or legal duties are unresolved.
- **Must be true:** capacity, coverage, service quality, cancellations, cost.
- **Stance:** Build (default) · Protect · never Activate, Expand. **Strategy:** S11 (also S09).
- **Lines:** L11 → L09 · alt. L12. **Gambits:** G05, G09. **First step:** M40 Capacity / Service Reliability Gate.
- **Who decides:** service owner. **Done when:** reliability and fill rate return to the agreed gate.
- **Example:** throttle ad spend until technicians can meet booking windows. **Tip:** a throttle is a success, not a failure, when supply is the constraint.

P20 · Trust-and-Quality Assurance

Reduce justified fear with real protections.

- **Use when:** mistrust blocks justified adoption, or early churn is high. **Don't use when:** a promised guarantee cannot be funded or honoured.
- **Must be true:** credentials, dispute handling, privacy and quality evidence.
- **Stance:** Build (default) · Activate, Co-create · never Expand. **Strategy:** S09 (also S14).
- **Lines:** L09 · alt. L20. **Gambits:** G10. **First step:** M41 Assured Pilot (M45 when churn is the signal).
- **Who decides:** operations with compliance. **Done when:** quality and complaint rates improve, verified independently.
- **Example:** transparent provider verification with a published remediation flow. **Tip:** fund the guarantee before you advertise it.

P22 · Supply Activation

Turn listed supply into available, accepted work.

- **Use when:** many listed suppliers, few accept jobs. **Don't use when:** providers lack competence or capacity.
- **Must be true:** onboarding, training, availability and fair terms.
- **Stance:** Build (default) · Probe · never Expand. **Strategy:** S11.
- **Lines:** L11 · alt. L17. **Gambits:** G05, G11. **First step:** M38 Provider Readiness Audit.
- **Who decides:** operations owner. **Done when:** accepted and completed work capacity is confirmed.

- **Example:** credential and book local providers for defined shifts. **Tip:** list only capacity a provider has accepted this week.

P24 · Activation Reliability

Make first value consistently reachable.

- **Use when:** conversion is high but drop-offs cluster in onboarding. **Don't use when:** core value is not yet demonstrated.
- **Must be true:** funnel events, consented failure recordings, error categories.
- **Stance:** Build (default) · Probe · never Expand. **Strategy:** S09 (also S10).
- **Lines:** L09 · alt. L20. **Gambits:** G01, G09. **First step:** M30 Friction Observation.
- **Who decides:** product / operations owner. **Done when:** time to first value and completion improve in a held-out cohort.
- **Example:** remove a repeated ID-verification step where lawful. **Tip:** fix the smallest verified obstacle first (M31).

P30 · First Market System Build

Assemble the minimum viable offer, route, supply, trust and economics.

- **Use when:** first commitments exist but transactions break. **Don't use when:** there is no safe, lawful delivery channel.
- **Must be true:** a service blueprint, handoffs, contingency, customer and provider terms.
- **Stance:** Build (default) · Co-create · never Expand. **Strategy:** S09.
- **Lines:** L09 · alt. L11. **Gambits:** G01, G09. **First step:** M36 Manual Fulfillment Proof.
- **Who decides:** market builder. **Done when:** end-to-end delivery is verified for a repeat sample.
- **Example:** coordinate intake, dispatch, payment and issue handling for a repair service. **Tip:** keep a human in every handoff until two cohorts pass.

Scale

P23 · Margin Integrity

Detect loss-making discounts, churn and attribution distortion.

- **Use when:** topline grows while contribution falls. **Don't use when:** reliable cost data or data rights are missing.
- **Must be true:** revenue, fees, incentives, human labour, refunds, payback.
- **Stance:** Protect (default) · Probe, Build · never Activate, Expand. **Strategy:** S12.
- **Lines:** L12 · alt. L16. **First step:** M43 True Contribution Rebuild.

- **Who decides:** finance and growth sponsor. **Done when:** corrected net economics drive the continue or pause decision.
- **Example:** creator commissions make booked orders unprofitable. **Tip:** rebuild margin per cohort, never on a blended average.

P25 · Channel Saturation and Renewal

Detect marginal decline and diversify thoughtfully.

- **Use when:** CPC rises or the same people see repeated outreach. **Don't use when:** the new channel is untested or breaks contact rights.
- **Must be true:** marginal cohort returns, creative fatigue, audience overlap.
- **Stance:** Probe (default) · Activate, Protect · never Expand. **Strategy:** S10 (also S12).
- **Lines:** L10 · alt. L18. **First step:** M47 Marginal Return Test.
- **Who decides:** growth sponsor. **Done when:** incremental cohort quality and marginal margin stabilize.
- **Example:** move to a referral test after search saturates. **Tip:** the last dollar matters, not the average dollar.

P27 · Geography Transfer

Validate repeatability across cultural and logistical boundaries.

- **Use when:** success in a first city prompts wider launch. **Don't use when:** the first-city sample or supply economics are atypical.
- **Must be true:** a matched market comparison, local authority, a holdout.
- **Stance:** Expand (default) · Scout, Probe. **Strategy:** S15 (also S13).
- **Lines:** L15 · alt. L13. **First step:** M50 Transferability Test.
- **Who decides:** regional expansion owner. **Done when:** the new territory shows independently verified positive economics.
- **Example:** pilot one adjacent city before national scaling. **Tip:** keep distinct Positions per territory; never roll a weak city into a strong average.

P28 · Adjacency Validation

Find a genuine next job near proven users.

- **Use when:** established users request related workflows. **Don't use when:** the request is one-off or weakly priced.
- **Must be true:** jobs, market boundary, switching and supply cost.
- **Stance:** Probe (default) · Co-create. **Strategy:** S15 (also S06).
- **Lines:** L03 → L06 · alt. L07. **First step:** M13 Adjacent Job Probe.

- **Who decides:** portfolio or product sponsor. **Done when:** the new use case earns independent paid usage.
- **Example:** extend invoice review into payment reconciliation. **Tip:** check who pays; adjacent jobs often have a different buyer.

P31 · Scale System Repair

Repair the engine rather than buy more traffic.

- **Use when:** channels look productive but quality or margin falls. **Don't use when:** there is no root-cause evidence for the proposed change.
- **Must be true:** cross-cohort metrics, provider economics, a process trace.
- **Stance:** Build (default) · Protect · never Expand. **Strategy:** S12 (also S10).
- **Lines:** L12 → L15 · alt. L20. **First step:** M43 True Contribution Rebuild.
- **Who decides:** Market Manager and sponsor. **Done when:** contribution and trust recover for a sustained period.
- **Example:** fix a dispatch bottleneck before doubling promotion. **Tip:** freeze spend while you diagnose; repairs are cheaper at lower volume.

Any stage

P26 · Permission and Compliance Review

Establish whether outreach and field conduct are permissible.

- **Use when:** sector restrictions, platform terms or consent rules are unknown. **Don't use when:** an expert is required and no permitted workaround exists (stop instead).
- **Must be true:** legal and platform policies; consent, retention and data maps.
- **Stance:** Protect (default) · Listen, Scout · never Activate, Expand. **Strategy:** S13 (also S16).
- **Lines:** L13 steps 1–2 when entering; L16 when an activity is in breach · alt. L17. **First step:** legal review (A22); M55 if the activity is live.
- **Who decides:** legal / compliance specialist. **Done when:** an approved route or an explicit prohibition with a safe stop.
- **Example:** no unconsented health-related targeting messages. **Tip:** run it before the first send, not after the first complaint.

P32 · Pause, Reframe or Retire

Stop effort and incentive bias from keeping a bad thesis alive.

- **Use when:** repeated disconfirmation, an ethics issue or negative margin. **Don't use when:** a safer, cheap investigation can still resolve high-value uncertainty.

- **Must be true:** an investment-to-learning ratio, obligations, a transition plan, lessons.
- **Stance:** Protect (default) · Listen, Probe · never Activate, Expand. **Strategy:** S16 (also S02).
- **Lines:** L16 · alt. L02. **First step:** M54 Pivot Hypothesis Draft (M55 if harm is live).
- **Who decides:** sponsor and governance owner. **Done when:** spend stops or is reallocated, participants are protected, lessons are kept.
- **Example:** discontinue an unviable local food-delivery wedge safely. **Tip:** decide the stop rule when you start, so stopping is not a debate.

11 Lines

A Line is a conditional, time-aware plan, not a funnel automation. Steps run in order; branches change the route; every Line has a plan window, stop and escalation rules, and a done test. Plan windows are illustrative research defaults, not SLAs; calibrate them per market and consent regime.

Explore

L01 · Territory Reconnaissance

Define the market boundary and make reality visible. Starts when a territory or market type is unmapped.

- **Steps:** register the Position version (A01) → triangulate sources (M05) → map audience sources (M06) → map local institutions (M07) → map alternatives (M15) → reconcile competing evidence (A05).
- **If… then…:** buyers inaccessible → L04 · a structural legal gate → P26, park.
- **Window:** 2–4 weeks. **Stop if:** a legal gate closes the territory. **Escalate if:** the scope cannot be bounded → sponsor.
- **Done when:** a market-system map with source limits and at least two alternative wedges.
- **Stance:** Listen (default) · Scout, Probe. **Used by:** P01, P03, P06. **Who decides:** Research owner with the field steward.

L02 · Disconfirming Discovery

Try to refute the current thesis cheaply. Starts when a strong assumption lacks behavioural proof.

- **Steps:** name the falsifier (A05) → recruit negative cases (M03) → run contradiction probes (M02) → attempt a meaningful action (M10) → compare explanations (A05).
- **If… then…:** decisive negative → L16 · undecidable → redesign the test (A15).

- **Window:** 1–3 weeks. **Stop if:** the falsifier is met. **Escalate if:** the sponsor disputes a decisive negative → independent critic.
- **Done when:** valid contradictory evidence changes the Position or bounds confidence.
- **Stance:** Probe (default) · Listen. **Used by:** P02, P03 · alt. P18, P32. **Who decides:** Research Lead with an independent critic.

L03 · Wedge Selection

Choose one segment instead of a diffuse TAM. Starts when many plausible buyers compete for scarce capacity.

- **Steps:** segment by job, trigger and access (M09) → model territory economics (A10) → rank options (M14) → prepare alternatives (A15) → route the decision (A16).
- **If… then…:** segment too small → M13 adjacency · segment inaccessible → L04.
- **Window:** 1–2 weeks. **Stop if:** no segment beats the no-action option. **Escalate if:** two wedges tie → sponsor picks.
- **Done when:** a narrow thesis is approved with credible alternatives and a locked test boundary.
- **Stance:** Scout (default) · Listen, Probe. **Used by:** P01, P04, P10, P28. **Who decides:** sponsor and Market Manager.

L04 · Access Bridge

Earn permission and trust for first interactions. Starts when buyers are hidden or local access is fragmented.

- **Steps:** map nodes (M07) → trusted introductions (M18) → record permission and contact owner (A19) → lawful field mapping (M19) → audit qualified access (M20).
- **If… then…:** trust refused → change path or partner · an opt-out → halt that contact everywhere (A57) · physical access needed → L17.
- **Window:** 2–4 weeks. **Stop if:** access would need deception. **Escalate if:** no route after two paths → Market Manager marks MP2 Can't reach.
- **Done when:** consented, qualified engagement with a comparable source trace.
- **Stance:** Scout (default) · Listen, Co-create. **Used by:** P07 · alt. P13, P16. **Who decides:** Market Architect manager.

Develop

L05 · Message and Offer Probe

Turn the problem into a proposition people understand. Starts when offer language is unproven or objections recur.

- **Steps:** capture buyer vocabulary and objections (M25) → approve two truthful variants (A23) → comprehension test (M22) → variant experiment (M23) → record responses (A24).
- **If… then…:** misunderstood → revise and retest · recurring objection → M29 · no real need → L02.
- **Window:** 1–3 weeks. **Stop if:** a variant needs an unsupportable claim. **Escalate if:** the brand owner rejects both variants.
- **Done when:** understanding and actual behaviour improve without false claims.
- **Stance:** Probe (default) · Listen, Co-create. **Used by:** P04, P09, P12, P15, P18 · alt. P02, P17. **Who decides:** brand owner with Research.

L06 · Behavioral Test

Seek the least-cost meaningful commitment. Starts when enthusiasm is not backed by action.

- **Steps:** construct a low-risk commitment option (A11) → check capacity (M40) → launch a capped test (A25) → ask for the action (M10) → receive outcomes and opt-outs (A12) → report against baseline (A47).
- **If… then…:** price is the blocker → M33 · an incentive distorts behaviour → adjust (G06 only with approval) · no action → L02.
- **Window:** 1–4 weeks. **Stop if:** cap hit, opt-out failure or misleading term. **Escalate if:** results are ambiguous at the cap → Market Manager.
- **Done when:** real commitments with stated quality, denominator and confidence.
- **Stance:** Probe (default) · Activate. **Used by:** P02, P06, P12, P14, P15, P28 · alt. P10, P11. **Who decides:** growth sponsor.

L07 · Design Partner Loop

Turn early co-design into adoption evidence. Starts when a complex buyer needs situated proof.

- **Steps:** agree reciprocal terms (M37) → approve the agreement (A40) → map buyer, budget and outcome owner (M17) → build a narrow outcome prototype (M28) → deliver the pilot output (A30) → read back the outcome (M56) → record the next decision (A15).
- **If… then…:** security or authority blocks live data → synthetic world · committee stall → M24 · price objection → G02 with approval.
- **Window:** 4–10 weeks. **Stop if:** the partner stops using it for two weeks. **Escalate if:** no economic buyer by mid-point → sponsor.
- **Done when:** pilot value is verified and the next decision is recorded.

- **Stance:** Co-create (default) · Probe. **Used by:** P10, P11, P17 · alt. P04, P28. **Who decides:** product or enterprise sponsor.

L08 · Channel Validation

Test productive intermediary distribution. Starts when a partner promises reach but conversion is unknown.

- **Steps:** audit the partner's qualified access (M20) → design the value exchange (M21) → set a non-exclusive test (M42) → launch a capped referred cohort (A25) → audit referrals (A20) → measure marginal return (M47).
- **If… then…:** untested exclusivity demanded → decline or G07 with approval · weak audience → change partner (L04) · promising but slow → G04.
- **Window:** 3–8 weeks. **Stop if:** the partner shares unconsented contacts. **Escalate if:** the partner requests binding terms → signatory.
- **Done when:** incremental, attributable activation and viable partner economics.
- **Stance:** Probe (default) · Co-create, Activate. **Used by:** P13, P21. **Who decides:** partnership owner.

Build

L09 · First Transaction Build

Connect demand, delivery, support, payment and quality. Starts when there is customer commitment but no working market mechanism.

- **Steps:** audit provider readiness (M38) → run a manual concierge transaction (M36) → operate the episode (A38) → reconcile payment, delivery and complaints (A39) → rebuild true contribution (M43) → read back the outcome (M56).
- **If… then…:** safety fails → M55 stop service · economics negative → L12 before any scale · tooling not ready → G09.
- **Window:** 3–8 weeks. **Stop if:** a safety incident. **Escalate if:** two consecutive failed deliveries → operations owner.
- **Done when:** completed genuine value with correct handling and proof (Gate 2).
- **Stance:** Build (default) · Co-create, Protect. **Used by:** P11, P19, P20, P24, P30 · alt. P08. **Who decides:** operations owner.

L11 · Supply–Demand Balance

Manage cold start, liquidity and provider readiness. Starts when the market lacks matching or service depth.

- **Steps:** map demand clusters (A08) → verify providers (M38) → seed liquidity (M39) → apply the capacity gate (M40) → track completed matches (A42) → record supply incidents (A44).
- **If… then…:** fill rate degrades → pause buyer growth (A43) · supply too thin → G05 or G11 with approval · subsidy unbounded → L12.
- **Window:** 4–10 weeks. **Stop if:** an unsafe provider is found (suspend that source). **Escalate if:** cancellations stay above the gate for two weeks.
- **Done when:** durable match quality inside an acceptable subsidy and cost envelope.
- **Stance:** Build (default) · Probe, Protect. **Used by:** P08, P19, P22 · alt. P30. **Who decides:** marketplace manager.

L17 · Human Field Mission

Run a physical-world investigation or action safely. Starts when digital systems cannot see local reality well enough.

- **Steps:** create the Mission (A28) → verify the Architect's capability and eligibility (A29) → dispatch with protocol (M19, M08 or M01) → record consented observations (A02) → code evidence and run independent QA (A04) → close (A60).
- **If… then…:** unsafe → withdraw (A57) · implausible or fabricated claims → quarantine and investigate · worker offline → explicit wait state and safety check.
- **Window:** hours to weeks by assignment. **Stop if:** worker or participant safety is at risk. **Escalate if:** the QA sample disagrees with submissions.
- **Done when:** accepted, source-backed outputs; the worker is paid; no open safety incident.
- **Stance:** Scout (default) · Listen, Probe, Build. **Used by:** alt. for P03, P05, P07, P22, P26. **Who decides:** Hipstraw field operations.

L20 · Post-Launch Reliability Pursuit

Own the market mechanism after acquisition. Starts when purchases or partner commitments create follow-through duties.

- **Steps:** set watches (A12) → observe activation events (A31) → diagnose retention and trust (M45) → correct root causes (M49) → verify the correction (A50) → read back outcomes (M56) → close or reopen (A60).
- **If… then…:** authority changes → stop affected effects (A57) · outcomes unverifiable → keep the Case open · a late refund → reopen and recalculate.
- **Window:** continuous for the mandate term. **Stop if:** the mandate ends (hand off open Cases). **Escalate if:** a guardrail is breached.

- **Done when:** customer value, delivery and financial effects are confirmed in independent sources.
- **Stance:** Build (default) · Protect. **Used by:** alt. for P20, P24, P31. **Who decides:** Market Operations manager.

Scale

L10 · Repeatable Acquisition

Turn isolated wins into reproducible acquisition. Starts when first transactions succeeded.

- **Steps:** freeze the cohort and assign it (A25) → instrument sources (A31) → expand a controlled cohort (M46) → test marginal return (M47) → diagnose retention (M45) → report incremental effects (A47).
- **If… then…:** marginal CAC spikes → throttle (A43) · retained value fails → back to L09 · one channel dominates → M48.
- **Window:** 4–12 weeks. **Stop if:** contribution turns negative for a cohort. **Escalate if:** the second cohort underperforms the first by more than the agreed band.
- **Done when:** healthy incremental cohort economics and reproducible execution (Gate 3).
- **Stance:** Activate (default) · Build, Expand. **Used by:** P25. **Who decides:** growth with finance.

L12 · Margin and Payback Gate

Control real incremental returns. Starts when discounts, referrals or regional scale are under way.

- **Steps:** rebuild true contribution (M43) → separate incremental from attributed sales (M47) → stress-test downside and payback (M44) → recompute net contribution (A46) → route the decision (A16).
- **If… then…:** evidence absent → stay in pilot · margin negative → stop spend (A43) · thesis broken → L16.
- **Window:** 2–5 weeks. **Stop if:** — (this Line is the stop check). **Escalate if:** finance and growth disagree on the cost basis.
- **Done when:** contribution and payback are independently reproducible.
- **Stance:** Protect (default) · Probe, Build. **Used by:** P23, P31 · alt. P15, P19. **Who decides:** finance sponsor.

L13 · Localized Entry

Adapt offer, evidence and channels to a territory. Starts when entry crosses a cultural or regulatory boundary.

- **Steps:** map local institutions (M07) → counsel and permissions (A22) → local interpreter Mission (M08) → compliance and language pilot (M51) → controlled field pilot (L17) → Review (A01).
- **If… then…:** compliance or safety blocked → no launch (L16) · buyer role differs → remap (M17).
- **Window:** 4–12 weeks. **Stop if:** counsel prohibits the route. **Escalate if:** a local partner demands prepaid exclusivity.
- **Done when:** field-observed local adoption and quality evidence.
- **Stance:** Scout (default) · Listen, Co-create. **Used by:** P05, P26 · alt. P27. **Who decides:** regional principal.

L14 · Community and Partner Loop

Make repeated, mutually useful participation durable. Starts when trusted nodes and advocates influence adoption.

- **Steps:** listen to the community (M01) → define reciprocal value (M21) → recruit authentic partners (M27) → convene and serve (M34) → enable an optional action (M10) → track retention (M45).
- **If… then…:** advocacy turns deceptive or coercive → stop (M55) · no benefit to members → reframe · a community needs seed money → G03.
- **Window:** 6–12 weeks. **Stop if:** undisclosed paid advocacy is found. **Escalate if:** a member complaint about pressure.
- **Done when:** earned repeat participation, trust and attributable referrals.
- **Stance:** Co-create (default) · Listen. **Used by:** P16, P29 · alt. P12, P14. **Who decides:** community steward.

L15 · Transfer and Scale

Validate a proven mechanism in an adjacent market. Starts when the current wedge passed Gate 3.

- **Steps:** transferability test (M50) → activate a held-out local study (A51) → local compliance and language pilot (M51) → controlled cohort expansion (M46) → rebuild contribution (M43) → scale release gate (M53) → authorize staged scale (A55).
- **If… then…:** new-market failure or core deterioration → stop replication and diagnose (M49) · transfer fails → L16 for that unit only.

- **Window:** 6–16 weeks. **Stop if:** the core market regresses. **Escalate if:** the held-out result conflicts with the core.
- **Done when:** an independent Gate 4 / Gate 5 pass with stable quality.
- **Stance:** Expand (default) · Probe. **Used by:** P27, P31. **Who decides:** sponsor or expansion lead.

Govern and exit

L16 · Reframe or Stop

Preserve learning, relationships, data rights and capital on exit. Starts when a hypothesis failed or a risk is unacceptable.

- **Steps:** log the reason (A56) → pause and remediate (M55) → suspend activities and revoke access (A57) → draft a pivot hypothesis (M54) → close or restart (A60).
- **If… then…:** immediate harm → M55 first, skip experiments · obligations exist → run the transition before closing.
- **Window:** immediate for safety stops; otherwise the next Review cycle. **Escalate if:** a customer obligation cannot be met → sponsor.
- **Done when:** a verified halt or handoff, and an evidence-backed new thesis if any.
- **Stance:** Protect (default). **Used by:** P26, P32 · alt. P21, P23. **Who decides:** sponsor and governance.

L18 · Campaign as Experiment

Run a campaign with a falsifiable claim and honest attribution. Starts when a distribution test has a credible hypothesis.

- **Steps:** define intervention and control (A15) → approve creatives (A23) and budget (A49) → launch capped (A25) → observe permitted events (A31) → read back outcomes (M56) → report incremental effect (A47).
- **If… then…:** misleading claim, opt-out failure or cost cap hit → pause at once (M55).
- **Window:** 1–8 weeks. **Stop if:** any rule 02, 05, 09 or 19 breach. **Escalate if:** the control is contaminated.
- **Done when:** incremental outcome, total cost, uncertainty and adverse effects are reported.
- **Stance:** Probe (default) · Activate. **Used by:** alt. for P06, P09, P25, P29. **Who decides:** campaign sponsor.

L19 · Pioneer Portfolio Review

Allocate scarce effort across competing Market Positions. Starts on the portfolio cadence or when many units are active.

- **Steps:** refresh all Positions (A01) → rank opportunities (M14) → prepare alternatives (A15) → route dispositions (A16) → set stage budgets (A49).
- **If… then…:** key evidence missing → fund a narrow test, not a program.
- **Window:** weekly or monthly. **Escalate if:** an unfunded commitment is found.
- **Done when:** a rationalized investment slate with no hidden unfunded commitments.
- **Stance:** any (management Review). **Used by:** alt. for P01. **Who decides:** Faculty Executive and sponsor.

12 Moves

A Move is a market intervention, not an API call. Every effectful Move needs an approved execution binding (a human, tool, service or agent); a Move without one stays SPECIFIED ONLY. A Move is not complete because a message was sent or a form submitted: it is complete when its done test is verified. **Protect / Pause may always run M55; anyone can stop.**

Stance column: ● default; × never. Stances not named are allowed only if the Line's stance allows them.

Move	Use when	Never when	Stance	Tasks	Done when
Ask and verify					
M01 Contextual Observation	Behaviour, workaround or setting is hidden	No lawful, consented observation channel	● Listen	A01 · A02 · A05	Validated observations anchored to context
M02 Interview Contradiction Probe	Enthusiasm lacks specific past behaviour	Probes would be leading or coercive	● Probe	A03 · A04	Supported and contested behaviour separated
M03 Disconfirming Probe	Research covers only friendly early adopters	Failure cases are cherry-picked	● Probe	A03 · A05	The claim is narrowed by adverse evidence
M04 Workaround Documentation	An unmet job shows up as manual work	It would expose protected operational secrets	● Listen	A02 · A06	A substitute map grounded in evidence
M05 Source Triangulation	A desk or anecdotal signal is material	No independent source exists (disclose the limit)	● Scout	A04 · A07	Conflicts and uncertainty documented

Move	Use when	Never when	Stance	Tasks	Done when
M06 Audience Source Mapping	Audience or buying access is unclear	Personal data would be harvested without lawful basis	● Scout	A01 · A08	A qualified, addressable route mapped
M07 Local Institution Mapping	New territory or regulated sector	It rests on stereotypes from a few intermediaries	● Scout	A01 · A09	A verified local ecosystem account
M08 Local Interpreter Mission	Remote inference may misread a region	The task is unsafe or the worker unqualified	● Scout	A28 · A29	Local claims independently checked
M09 Archetype Segmentation	An “everyone” strategy	Segmenting by a sensitive attribute without purpose or compliance	● Scout	A08 · A10	Testable audience boundaries
M11 Interview Recruitment	A specific segment must be tested	Uncontrolled spam or insider-only samples	● Listen · × Protect	A08 · A13	An auditable eligible sample
M12 Trigger Verification	Urgency is tied to an event	The event is rumour	● Scout	A07 · A14	Date, applicability and affected population verified
M14 Portfolio Opportunity Ranking	Several funded options compete	Weights would hide a hard gate	● Scout	A15 · A16	A decision report with uncertainty
M15 Alternative Mapping	Displacement or new category	The comparison is invented or unfair	● Scout	A01 · A10	A credible switching map
M17 Buyer Job / Budget Map	B2B adoption involves several principals	Claims are made without authority	● Listen	A08 · A09	The true buying process recorded
M24 Buying Committee Map	The champion cannot progress alone	It bypasses procurement or privacy controls	● Co-create	A08 · A26	A real sponsor and decision route
M25 Objection Evidence Capture	Repeated stalls or drop-offs	Only unverified sales summaries exist	● Listen	A04 · A27	Causes prioritized by validity
M29 Objection Taxonomy	Similar declines across prospects	Every objection is blamed on price	● Listen	A04 · A27	Ranked, actionable gaps by segment
Access and partners					
M18 Trusted Introduction	A segment is hard to reach directly	The agent would claim a false affiliation	● Scout · × Protect	A18 · A19	An accepted, consented qualified introduction

Move	Use when	Never when	Stance	Tasks	Done when
M19 Trade / Street Mapping	The market is physically fragmented	Photography or intercepts are not permitted	● Scout · × Protect	A28 · A06	Verified coverage and deviations reported
M20 Channel Qualification Audit	A partner claims a large audience	Exclusivity is demanded before a pilot	● Probe	A20 · A21	A qualified introduced cohort observed
M21 Partner Value Exchange Design	Distribution needs institutional support	Unbounded inducement or a conflict	● Co-create · × Listen	A21 · A22	A balanced, approved partner proposal
M26 Creator Audience Fit Test	An influencer or community partnership is offered	Audience unverifiable or endorsement undisclosed	● Probe · × Protect	A20 · A23	Qualified actions, not impressions
M27 Authentic Partner Mission	Local trust or community learning is needed	A paid advocate is presented as independent	● Co-create · × Protect	A18 · A29	Continued trust and voluntary engagement
M42 Nonexclusive Channel Test	A partner asks for exclusivity	No credible value or no legal review	● Probe · × Listen, Scout, Protect	A21 · A22	Evidence for or against later exclusivity
M52 Partner Enablement Kit	A partner wants a scalable motion	Claims unreviewed or kit untested	● Expand · × Listen, Scout, Probe	A23 · A54	The partner runs a compliant test independently
Offer and conversion					
M10 Behavioral Commitment Test	Positive reactions do not prove intent	No delivery capacity, or misleading terms	● Probe · × Listen, Scout, Protect	A11 · A12	Observed response with denominator and non-response
M13 Adjacent Job Probe	A cross-sell or adjacency hypothesis	The relationship is assumed to grant demand	● Probe · × Protect	A03 · A11	Independent commitment for the adjacent job
M16 Switching Friction Test	Buyers like the idea but stay with the incumbent	Migration cannot be supported safely	● Probe · × Listen	A11 · A17	An actual switch or a quantified honest refusal
M22 Proposition Comprehension Test	New category or complex value claim	The simplification misleads	● Probe	A23 · A24	Respondents correctly describe the value
M23 Message Variant Experiment	Positioning is under test	A variant uses fabricated proof	● Probe · × Listen, Protect	A23 · A25	Difference in qualified action estimated

Move	Use when	Never when	Stance	Tasks	Done when
M28 Outcome Prototype	An enterprise deal needs workflow evidence	No authority to touch real customer data	● Co-create · × Listen	A11 · A30	The customer observes measurable value
M30 Friction Observation	Many registrations, no first value	Session monitoring is not authorized	● Build	A31 · A32	Root-cause friction identified
M31 First-Value Path Repair	A specific activation failure is supported	The change hides a safety or compliance step	● Build	A33 · A30	Better first-value completion, no new harm
M32 Trial Meaningfulness Audit	Trials start but buyers invest no effort	There is no proof the trial can succeed	● Probe	A31 · A04	Valid trial learning, not hollow sign-ups
M33 Price / Value Exchange Probe	Paid conversion lags perceived need	Hidden fees or misleading pre-commitment	● Probe · × Listen, Scout, Protect	A11 · A34	Observed willingness to pay and retained value
M34 Live Demo Event	In-person context shows value better	A vanity crowd or an unsafe venue	● Activate · × Listen, Protect	A35 · A36	Participants understand and can act voluntarily
M35 Post-Event Qualification	Sign-ups were collected at an event	No permission to follow up	● Activate · × Protect	A37 · A11	Verified qualified responses; opt-outs respected
M37 Design Partner Terms	An early customer helps shape the offer	Unreasonable unpaid research extraction	● Co-create · × Listen, Scout	A21 · A40	Partner rights and commitments clear
M41 Assured Pilot	Fear of poor service blocks conversion	The guarantee cannot be honoured	● Activate · × Listen, Scout, Protect	A38 · A45	Safe outcomes and resolved remedies verified
Supply and delivery					
M36 Manual Fulfillment Proof	The product is immature but a demand test is valuable	People unsafe or unqualified, or economics hidden	● Build · × Listen	A38 · A39	Delivery completed; cost and defects accounted
M38 Provider Readiness Audit	The market has nominal supply	Missing licences or unsafe operations	● Build	A28 · A41	Real available capacity confirmed locally
M39 Liquidity Seeding	Two-sided cold start	Subsidy would hide unsustainable demand	● Build · × Listen, Protect	A38 · A42	Matched, fulfilled transactions within bounds

Move	Use when	Never when	Stance	Tasks	Done when
M40 Capacity / Service Reliability Gate	Service failures rise with acquisition	An unsafe provider or material complaint is unresolved (stop instead)	● Build	A43 · A44	The approved safe capacity limit is observed
M45 Retention / Trust Diagnosis	High conversion, falling repeat use	Data is missing or privacy basis invalid	● Build	A31 · A48	Actionable true churn causes
M49 Root-Cause System Correction	Repeated fulfillment or conversion errors	Causality inferred from one episode	● Build	A33 · A50	Repeat failure declines in an independent cohort
Economics and scale					
M43 True Contribution Rebuild	Reported success is suspect	Costs are missing without disclosure	● Protect	A46 · A47	An auditable incremental contribution range
M44 Downside / Payback Scenario	A large budget or costly Missions are proposed	Future benefits are described as certain	● Protect	A46 · A16	Bounded exposure and an explicit stop threshold
M46 Controlled Cohort Expansion	One cohort shows promising repeatability	Delivery capacity is unverified	● Expand · × Listen, Scout, Probe, Protect	A25 · A49	The scale gate re-evaluated on a new sample
M47 Marginal Return Test	Channels scale and efficiency drops	No attribution basis	● Probe	A47 · A49	Capped incremental ROI reported
M48 Channel Mix Diversification	One channel saturating or dependent	Diversification hides low-quality leads	● Probe · × Protect	A20 · A25	Qualified yield improves with diversified risk
M50 Transferability Test	Replication beyond the known market type	Language, culture or institutions assumed constant	● Expand	A51 · A52	Transfer boundaries recorded
M51 Local Compliance / Language Pilot	Expansion into a new geography	No qualified legal and linguistic route	● Scout	A28 · A53	The local conduct and quality gate passed
M53 Scale Release Gate	The portfolio wants a bigger launch	One metric overrides trust or margin	● Expand · × Listen, Scout, Probe	A55 · A16	A signed decision with bounds, stage and stop rule
Close out and stop					

Move	Use when	Never when	Stance	Tasks	Done when
M54 Pivot Hypothesis Draft	The core thesis failed but assets remain	The pivot is an unsupported success story	● Protect	A15 · A56	A new falsifiable thesis, not recycled optimism
M55 Pause / Remediate Intervention	Consent, safety, quality, economics or rights fail	Never delayed for an experiment	● Protect (allowed in every stance)	A43 · A57	Affected activity stopped and harm resolved
M56 Outcome Readback	A campaign or transaction outcome is reported	A dashboard event is taken as fulfillment	● Build	A58 · A59	The realized outcome logged once, with attribution

13 Gambits

A Gambit knowingly gives something up for a bigger, testable market advance. Every Gambit needs a maximum loss, an end date, a fallback and a named approver, and never runs on weak evidence. Agents can model Gambits but never authorize them. Every card ends with a **net-value check**: the test that the get is actually worth more than the give, over the whole term.

Gambit	Give	Get	Max loss (illustrative)	Fallback	Approver
G01 Concierge service for learning	Free high-touch onboarding hours	Revealed activation barriers, first-value proof	6 h × 10 users × $80/h = $4,800	Self-serve pilot	Program sponsor
G02 Paid design partner discount	Discounted first paid pilot	Adoption evidence and a permissioned reference	40% of $20,000 = $8,000 per partner	Standard paid pilot	Commercial sponsor
G03 Local community seed grant	Capped event or community budget	Authentic participation, market intelligence	₹1,50,000 cash + 40 Architect hours	Independent research	Community and finance owners
G04 Limited reseller incentive	Short-term referral revenue share	Qualified, activated buyers	15% of first-year revenue, capped at $10,000	Direct sales route	Partner signatory
G05 Supply readiness guarantee	Paid reserved local capacity	Reliable matching and availability	40 slots/week × ₹300 × 6 weeks = ₹72,000	Smaller service zones	Operations and finance

Gambit	Give	Get	Max loss (illustrative)	Fallback	Approver
G06 Introductory price staircase	Lower initial price	Learning on adoption and step-up willingness	Discount + churn at step-up	Fixed-price test	Pricing owner
G07 One-neighborhood exclusivity	Temporary territory preference	A trusted partner's committed coverage	Foregone partners in that area for the term	Non-exclusive pilot (M42)	Legal and partnership owner
G08 Partner co-marketing investment	Field, content or event resources	A productive co-created channel	Labour + media + cash cap	Single-company pilot	Marketing sponsor
G09 Manual service bridge	Interim labour-intensive delivery	Demand proof while tooling matures	Labour deficit + service liability	Park onboarding	Operational sponsor
G10 Beta guarantee / risk reversal	A bounded remedy obligation	Lower justified buyer fear	₹500 × 200 bookings = ₹1,00,000 reserve	Proof-first offer, no guarantee	Finance and Legal
G11 Micro-market subsidy	Time-boxed provider or user incentive	Two-sided liquidity and learning	Total subsidy + adverse selection	Smaller matching market	Marketplace sponsor
G12 Open research / public benchmark	Selected anonymized method findings	Ecosystem trust and participation	Research and IP disclosure cost	Private cohort report	Research / editorial board

G01 · Concierge service for learning

- **Use when:** activation fails for unknown reasons and the first users are few and valuable. **Don't use when:** the concierge would hide that the product cannot deliver, or hours are uncapped.
- **Must be true:** a user cap, an hour cap, an end date and a plan to turn findings into M31 fixes.
- **Stance:** Build (default) · Probe, Co-create. **Used with:** P11, P24, P30.
- **Net-value check:** worth it only if the fixes it finds lift completion for the next, un-concierged cohort. Count the hours in M43.

G02 · Paid design partner discount

- **Use when:** an enterprise buyer needs proof and budget friction blocks a full-price pilot. **Don't use when:** the partner has no economic buyer, or the pilot would be free (no skin in the game).

- **Must be true:** written success criteria and agreed reference terms.
- **Stance:** Co-create (default) · Activate. **Used with:** P04, P10, P11, P15, P17.
- **Net-value check:** the discount must be smaller than the value of a verified reference and the adoption evidence. Never discount the renewal price.

G03 · Local community seed grant

- **Use when:** community trust gates access. **Don't use when:** the grant would buy advocacy or disclosure is unclear.
- **Must be true:** public disclosure and no strings on members' opinions.
- **Stance:** Co-create (default) · Probe. **Used with:** P07, P14, P16, P29.
- **Net-value check:** value = qualified introductions and insight, never attendance.

G04 · Limited reseller incentive

- **Use when:** the partner has passed M20 (proven qualified access). **Don't use when:** it would pay on leads rather than activations, or is uncapped.
- **Must be true:** commission paid only on verified activation; an end date.
- **Stance:** Activate (default) · Probe, Expand. **Used with:** P13, P21.
- **Net-value check:** commission per activated buyer must be below direct acquisition cost for the same cohort.

G05 · Supply readiness guarantee

- **Use when:** demand is proven and supply is unreliable. **Don't use when:** demand is unproven or providers are unverified.
- **Must be true:** verified providers, defined slots, an end date.
- **Stance:** Build (default) · Activate. **Used with:** P08, P19, P22.
- **Net-value check:** unused reserved slots are pure loss. Track utilization weekly; below 60% for two weeks, shrink the reservation.

G06 · Introductory price staircase

- **Use when:** price friction blocks trial of a valuable offer. **Don't use when:** the offer misfits (run P18 first) or the step-up is not disclosed.
- **Must be true:** the full price and step dates disclosed upfront.
- **Stance:** Activate (default) · Probe · never Expand. **Used with:** P02, P15, P18.
- **Net-value check:** compare cohort revenue through the step-up with a fixed-price cohort. A staircase that loses more at step-up than it gains in trial is negative.

G07 · One-neighborhood exclusivity

- **Use when:** the partner's local trust is the access route and alternatives are weak. **Don't use when:** before M42 evidence; open-ended; any competition-law risk.
- **Must be true:** one territory, at most 6 months, and a performance floor that ends exclusivity if missed.
- **Stance:** Co-create (default) · Activate, Build · never Probe. **Used with:** P05, P07, P21.
- **Net-value check:** price the excluded partners' option value, not just the chosen partner's promise.

G08 · Partner co-marketing investment

- **Use when:** the partner channel is validated (L08 done). **Don't use when:** it is vanity co-branding.
- **Must be true:** joint qualification and attribution rules.
- **Stance:** Activate (default) · Co-create, Expand. **Used with:** P13, P16, P21.
- **Net-value check:** incremental activated buyers from the joint cohort, net of the partner's own baseline.

G09 · Manual service bridge

- **Use when:** demand is real and tooling is not ready. **Don't use when:** it is unsafe, labour terms are unclear, or it is drifting into permanence.
- **Must be true:** an end date, a cost cap, honestly set customer expectations.
- **Stance:** Build (default) · Co-create · never Expand. **Used with:** P19, P24, P30.
- **Net-value check:** include bridge labour in contribution. If the economics only work by hand at a loss, they do not work.

G10 · Beta guarantee / risk reversal

- **Use when:** buyer fear is justified by past market failures and operations can deliver. **Don't use when:** the guarantee is unfunded.
- **Must be true:** a funded reserve and plain-language terms.
- **Stance:** Activate (default) · Build, Expand. **Used with:** P10, P20.
- **Net-value check:** extra verified conversions × contribution must exceed claims paid plus reserve cost of capital.

G11 · Micro-market subsidy

- **Use when:** a cold start in one dense micro-market. **Don't use when:** the subsidy would mask negative economics, or there is no end date.
- **Must be true:** the reprice date announced at the start.

- **Stance:** Build (default) · Probe · never Expand. **Used with:** P08, P22.
- **Net-value check:** the result is retention on both sides after the subsidy ends, not volume during it.

G12 · Open research / public benchmark

- **Use when:** category education matters and Hipstraw has publishable method findings. **Don't use when:** findings include client data or are promotional.
- **Must be true:** publication rights, methodology disclosure and a conflict review.
- **Stance:** Co-create (default) · Build, Expand. **Used with:** P12.
- **Net-value check:** inbound qualified participation attributable to the publication, against the IP given away.

14 Actions

Actions are the auditable effects agents and people execute. They are ordered by consequence: the further down, the more authority they need. Every Action leaves a linked artifact, the responsible actor, a time, the source version and a receipt. **Stopping or reducing is always allowed; starting or increasing needs the authority shown.** A POST response or a submitted draft is never proof of a market effect.

Tier 1 · Read, evaluate and record

ID	Action	Shows in activity as	Who can run it	Undo
A01	Register Market Position version	Registered Position v7 for Bengaluru appliance repair	Agent	New version
A02	Record consented field observation	Logged observation: 3 repair shops, consent on file	Agent · Architect	Quarantine
A03	Store source and provenance	Stored source: municipal trade register, as of 1 Oct	Agent	—
A04	Code interview or probe evidence	Coded 12 interviews: 4 contradict thesis	Agent	Recode
A05	Reconcile competing hypothesis evidence	Compared two explanations for low replies	Agent	—

ID	Action	Shows in activity as	Who can run it	Undo
A06	Validate permitted evidence access	Checked data rights for CRM export: allowed	Agent	—
A07	Observe source event and freshness	Flagged stale price list (92 days)	Agent	—
A08	Create archetype or role segmentation	Segmented RevOps vs CIO buyers	Agent	New version
A09	Map named market institutions	Mapped 6 salon associations	Agent	New version
A10	Create comparable territory economics	Modelled cost-to-serve for 3 wedges	Agent	New version
A14	Confirm external trigger and safe cutoff	Verified rule takes effect 1 Jan; cutoff 1 Dec	Agent	—
A17	Record switched user cost and reason	Recorded switch: 9 hours migration, reason “faster close”	Agent	—
A20	Audit partner-qualified access	Audited partner list: 60 of 1,000 eligible	Agent	—
A24	Record comprehension response	14 of 20 restated the value correctly	Agent	—
A26	Prepare buying-committee decision map	Mapped 4 approvers; security is the veto	Agent	New version
A27	Classify objection evidence	Classified 31 objections; 12 onboarding	Agent	Reclassify
A31	Observe permitted activation events	Observed 140 of 2,100 sign-ups activated	Agent	—
A32	Assess source-specific conversion failures	Creator traffic converts at 1/5 of referral	Agent	—
A46	Recompute full net contribution	Contribution after refunds and commissions: −₹38 per order	Agent	New version
A47	Report incremental effects with uncertainty	Incremental paid users: 18 (range 11–25)	Agent	New version

ID	Action	Shows in activity as	Who can run it	Undo
A48	Analyze retention and cohort evidence	Cohort 1 week-4 retention 41%	Agent	New version
A52	Score geographic transfer limitations	Transfer risk high: buyer role differs	Agent	New version

Tier 2 · Internal coordination

ID	Action	Shows in activity as	Who can run it	Undo
A15	Prepare decision alternatives	Prepared 3 options incl. no action	Agent	Yes
A16	Route decision or approval	Sent scale decision to the sponsor	Agent	Yes
A19	Record recipient permission and contact owner	Contact owner set: Market Architect R.	Agent	Yes
A37	Reconcile event-to-buyer follow-up	Matched 23 event sign-ups to consent records	Agent	Yes
A56	Log pivot and competing hypothesis	Logged pivot: salons value training over equipment	Agent	Yes

Tier 3 · Participant and market contact

ID	Action	Shows in activity as	Who can run it	Undo
A11	Construct a low-risk commitment option	Built a ₹499 pilot booking offer	Agent; principal approves before use	Yes, before sending
A12	Receive outcome and legitimate opt-out	Opt-out received; suppressed in all channels	Agent	—
A13	Recruit participants under an approved protocol	Invited 30 owners under protocol v2	Agent or Architect (contact permission)	No (sent)

ID	Action	Shows in activity as	Who can run it	Undo
A18	Create a scoped partner engagement	Opened engagement with Trade Association X	Agent + approval	Yes
A28	Create a human field Mission	Mission H-MSN-014 scoped: 2 neighborhoods	Agent + Mission coordinator approval	Yes, before dispatch
A29	Verify Market Architect capability and eligibility	Verified Scout: Kannada, safety induction done	Agent + field operations	Yes

Tier 4 · Effectful market operations

ID	Action	Shows in activity as	Who can run it	Undo
A23	Approve accurate claim or creative versions	Approved variant B; variant A refused (scarcity claim)	Brand owner; agent prepares	Withdraw
A25	Launch a capped test and cohort assignment	Launched test: 200 households, ₹15,000 cap	Agent in Approved-effect mode	Stop at once
A30	Deliver a safe pilot output receipt	Delivered exception report to design partner	Agent + approval	No
A33	Publish a tested product or onboarding change	Removed duplicate ID step in onboarding	Product owner; agent prepares	Roll back
A34	Publish an approved price test	Price test live: ₹499 vs ₹599	Pricing owner; agent executes	Stop at once
A35	Set event consent, venue and staffing	Venue booked; consent form v3	Event lead	Cancel
A36	Conduct an accessible, permitted event	Demo held: 41 attendees, 17 salon owners	Event lead + Architects	No
A38	Operate a manual fulfillment episode	Completed repair job #12 by hand	Operations + Architect	No

ID	Action	Shows in activity as	Who can run it	Undo
A39	Reconcile payment, delivery and complaints	Job #12 paid, delivered, no complaint	Agent + approval	Correct
A41	Check provider capability and credential proof	10 providers checked; 6 verified	Agent + operations approval	Re-check
A42	Track a completed supply–demand match	Match completed in 3 h 10 min	Agent	Correct
A43	Throttle unsafe or unprofitable demand	Paused bookings in Indiranagar	Agent may throttle; resuming needs approval	Resume via Review
A44	Record supply-side incidents and quality	Logged 3 cancellations, provider P-07	Agent	Correct
A45	Verify an offered remedial guarantee	Reserve funded: ₹1,00,000	Finance	—
A51	Activate a held-out local study	HSR Layout opened as held-out unit	Agent + sponsor approval	Stop
A53	Validate local language and compliance claims	Counsel approved messaging route	Specialist	—
A54	Publish a partner operating package	Partner kit v1 shared with 2 dealers	Partner owner; agent prepares	Withdraw
A57	Suspend activities and revoke access	Suspended all outreach to list L-3	Anyone, at once	Restore via Review

Tier 5 · Consequential commitments

ID	Action	Shows in activity as	Who can run it	Undo
A21	Prepare partnership terms and authority check	Drafted non-binding terms; signatory confirmed	Agent drafts; signing is human only	Yes, before signature

ID	Action	Shows in activity as	Who can run it	Undo
A22	Review partner legal and compliance constraints	Legal: exclusivity limited to 6 months	Legal / compliance only	—
A40	Approve design partner agreements	Design partner agreement signed	Human only (signatory)	No
A49	Approve an experimental channel budget	Budget approved: $6,000, 4 weeks	Sponsor or budget approver	No
A55	Authorize staged market scale	Scale stage 1 authorized with stop rule	Investment authority only	No

Tier 6 · Outcome and learning

ID	Action	Shows in activity as	Who can run it	Undo
A50	Verify a recurring process correction	Dispatch fix held for 2 cohorts	Independent verifier	—
A58	Fetch an authoritative effect receipt	Payment receipt fetched for job #12	Agent	—
A59	Record verified outcome and ledger attribution	Outcome logged once: 1 paid, delivered repair	Agent	Correct
A60	Finalize case closure and review	Case closed; next Review 3 Nov	Case owner	Reopen

Part E · Worked cases

Six cases traced from Position to Action, with what would change under different evidence. All are synthetic teaching worlds; names, numbers and results are illustrative, not client results or forecasts.

15 Six cases, end to end

C1 · Vertical B2B SaaS wedge

Enterprise design-partner market (AR04, AR10). A generic agentic operations product is looking for its first market among U.S. Series B/C companies. Of 10 exploratory conversations, 5 CIOs are enthusiastic but none can name a budget. 3 RevOps leaders describe a recurring exception-management burden of about two days every month-end close.

Position: MP1 Need · Hypothesis (strong for RevOps, weak for CIOs) · MP2 Buyers · Reachable (RevOps) · MP3 Offer · Concept · MP4 Route · Untested · MP6 Economics · Not modeled. Binding constraint: MP1.

Stance	Probe (default for MP1 Hypothesis). Activate and Expand ruled out by MP1 and MP3.
Strategy	S03 Prioritize a market wedge, then S06 Create a credible first commitment
Play	P04 Vertical Wedge Selection (with P02)
Lines	L03 Wedge Selection → L07 Design Partner Loop
Steps	M09 segment RevOps vs CIO · M17 buyer and budget map · M24 committee map · M37 design-partner terms · M10 ask for a paid slot
Gambit option	G02: $20,000 list, 40% off = $12,000 per partner, two partners; max loss $16,000
Actions	A08 · A26 · A15 · A16 · A21 (draft) · A40 (human signs) · A30 · A58 · A59
Done when	Two paying partners use it on live data for 8 weeks and a next decision is recorded. A signed discovery agreement is not the result.
What would change	**CIO interest stays, no operator pain:** re-evaluate the persona; drop executive vanity metrics. **One buyer wants bespoke:** scope a reusable narrow outcome and cost the customization. **Pilot signed, no data access:** synthetic world; back to the authority map. **Two pilots show adoption and budget:** run L10 with an independent cohort before expanding.

C2 · Bengaluru appliance repair

Fragmented local services (AR08, AR15). A principal wants AI-assisted booking for appliance repair in two neighborhoods, Indiranagar and Koramangala. Households are enthusiastic in conversation. Four Market Scouts check 10 listed providers: 6 are verified and available. The first 20 user-requested bookings at ₹499 a visit produce 17 completed jobs and 3 provider cancellations (15%, against a 10% gate). Consent for WhatsApp follow-up is unclear for some users.

Position: MP1 Need · Hypothesis · MP2 Buyers · Reachable (under-sampled) · MP4 Route · Untested (messaging consent pending) · MP5 Delivery · Fragile · MP6 Economics · Assumed · MP7 · First of its kind. Binding constraint: MP5.

Stance	Scout during field mapping; Build after the supply check. Expand ruled out by MP5, MP6 and MP7.
Strategy	S04 Establish trusted market access → S11 Develop market liquidity → S09 Build a viable transaction
Play	P07 Street / Trade Access Bridge, then P19 Supply / Delivery Balancing (with P22)
Lines	L17 Human Field Mission → L11 Supply–Demand Balance → L09 First Transaction Build
Steps	M19 trade mapping · M38 provider readiness · M40 capacity gate (cancellations 15% > 10%: throttle) · M36 manual fulfillment
Gambit option	G05 supply readiness guarantee, 40 slots/week × ₹300 × 6 weeks = ₹72,000 max, only once demand repeats. G11 not recommended yet.
Actions	A28 · A29 · A41 · A13 (opt-in only) · A38 · A39 · A43 (pause Indiranagar bookings) · A44 · A58 · A59
Done when	Gate 2: paid, fulfilled bookings, cancellations below 10% for two consecutive weeks, complaints resolved, contribution measured with real costs.
What would change	**A provider keeps cancelling:** suspend that source; stop promotion until capacity is fixed. **Customers ask for price assurance:** G10 with a funded reserve. **A chat group is offered as an audience:** membership is not marketing consent (rule 02). **Three jobs praised, no repeats:** keep watching; no scale claim. **Koramangala passes Gates 2 and 3:** open HSR Layout as a held-out unit (L15), not city-wide.

C3 · Independent salons

Fragmented local trade (AR08). An equipment vendor wants to reach independent salons in a mid-sized U.S. metro. $4,000 of paid online campaigns produced 3,100 clicks and 2 qualified demos. Owners buy through supplier relationships and peer demonstrations. A Scout Mission maps 25 owners across two neighborhoods; a local demo draws 41 attendees, of whom 17 are salon owners.

Position: MP1 Need · Hypothesis · MP2 Buyers · Can't reach (online) · MP3 Offer · Concept · MP4 Route · Piloting (paid online failing). Binding constraint: MP2.

Stance	Scout, moving to Co-create once owners engage. Activate ruled out by MP1 and MP3.
Strategy	S04 Establish trusted market access and S14 Compound partnerships and community
Play	P07 Street / Trade Access Bridge and P14 Live Demand Event
Lines	L04 Access Bridge · L17 Human Field Mission · L06 Behavioral Test (the event)
Steps	M19 lawful field mapping · M18 warm introductions · M34 opt-in demo · M35 post-event qualification
Gambit option	G03 seed grant to a salon association's training evening, if disclosed and capped
Actions	A28 · A19 · A35 · A36 · A37 · A11 (no-obligation 30-day pilot, published terms)
Done when	Eligible owner conversations, demo-to-paid conversion and partner costs are reported. Footfall is not the result.
What would change	**Popular event, mostly other vendors:** correct the sample; no success claim. **Salons value training over the product:** log the pivot (A56); test education-as-product (P18). **A creator offers fake testimonials:** decline (rule 04). **A distributor asks for exclusivity:** G07 only with approved, bounded economics.

C4 · New-category, creator-led consumer service

New category (AR02, AR09). Creator videos for a service people don't know they can ask for reach 400,000 views. Results: 2,100 sign-ups, 140 activated (6.7%), 18 paid. Sponsorship spend was $24,000, so each paid user cost about $1,333. The founder proposes doubling sponsorship.

Position: MP1 Need · Hypothesis · MP2 Buyers · Engaged (broad, low quality) · MP3 Offer · Prototype (not understood) · MP4 Route · Piloting · MP6 Economics · Assumed. Binding constraint: MP3.

Stance	Probe. Expand ruled out by MP1, MP3 and MP4.
Strategy	S05 Make the proposition intelligible and S12 Protect unit economics
Play	P12 Category Education to Action and P29 Creator / Community Fit
Lines	L05 Message and Offer Probe → L06 Behavioral Test → L12 Margin and Payback Gate
Steps	M26 audience fit and disclosure · M22 problem-language variants · M10 meaningful trial or payment in a capped cohort · M43 true contribution
Gambit option	None. Doubling sponsorship is spend, not a Gambit; rule 13 blocks it until Gate 1 is met.
Actions	A31 · A32 · A23 · A25 · A46 · A47
Done when	Incremental qualified acquisition cost and delivered value are reported, with inferred reach excluded.
What would change	**Reach persists, no sign-ups:** buy no more views; change the segment or stop. **Viewers understand but can't get the service:** fix supply, not the message. **Followers are mostly in irrelevant geographies:** reclassify qualified reach. **M43 shows contribution is negative:** MP6 becomes Negative; stance moves to Protect (§7.1) and spend stops. **An independent channel yields better buyers:** diversify (M48).

C5 · Industrial distributor network

Channel-led distribution (AR11). A manufacturer selling through 140 dealers is considering a digital replenishment and field-support service. Dealers fear that manufacturer-direct software will cannibalize their customer relationships. The opportunity may require new incentives and workflows, not just an app.

Position: MP1 Need · Hypothesis · MP2 Buyers · Reachable through dealers · MP4 Route · Untested · MP5 Delivery · Fragile (channel conflict) · MP6 Economics · Not modeled. Binding constraint: MP5.

Stance	Listen, moving to Co-create with willing dealers.
Strategy	S08 Unlock channel leverage and S14 Compound partnerships and community
Play	P21 Partner Economics and Governance (with P13)
Lines	L08 Channel Validation · L14 Community and Partner Loop
Steps	M17 map manufacturer, dealer and end-user positions separately · M21 value exchange · M42 non-exclusive test with 3 dealers in one territory · M47 against a no-action baseline
Gambit option	G08 co-marketing for the 3 pilot dealers, capped at $15,000. G07 not recommended.
Actions	A09 · A21 (draft only) · A22 · A18 · A25 · A47
Done when	Combined customer and dealer economics beat the no-action baseline without taking over dealer relationships.
What would change	**A dealer won't share customer data:** use scoped joint outcomes; no coercion. **End users love it, dealer economics fall:** pause expansion; redesign incentives (P23). **The manufacturer wants exclusive terms for all dealers:** non-exclusive pilot with Legal. **One dealer improves:** test across unlike dealers before scale (M50).

C6 · Cross-border B2B entry, Southeast Asia

Regional entry (AR05). A U.S. software company ran one English-language campaign across 6 countries; reply rates ranged from 0.4% to 3.1%. Procurement routines, buyer identities and partner expectations differ by country. A local consultant reports a “large pipeline” with no named accounts.

Position: MP2 Buyers · Unknown per country · MP4 Route · Untested · MP5 Delivery · Unknown (institutions) · MP6 Economics · Not modeled · MP7 · Repeatable at home, Gate 4 not met. Binding constraint: MP2.

Stance	Scout. Expand ruled out by MP2 and MP6.

Strategy	S13 Establish regional legitimacy. S15 is deferred until Gate 4.
Play	P05 Local Context Translation, P26 Permission and Compliance Review, later P27 Geography Transfer
Lines	L13 Localized Entry
Steps	M07 institution map · legal review (A22) · M08 interpreter Mission per country · M51 pilot with one credible partner · M50 against the U.S. baseline
Gambit option	None. A request for prepaid exclusivity gets M42 or a decline.
Actions	A09 · A22 · A28 · A29 · A53 · A51 · A52
Done when	Each country has its own Position with buyer path, value and unit economics against the U.S. baseline.
What would change	**A country's rules prohibit the campaign route:** no launch; ask counsel for lawful alternatives. **The consultant's pipeline has no IDs:** classify as unsupported (rules 01, 03). **A partner wants prepaid exclusivity:** M42 or decline. **One country validates, the next doesn't:** keep separate Positions; no regional roll-up.

Part F · Recommendations and upkeep

Common mistakes, tips by role, and how the playbook stays current.

16 Recommendations and common mistakes

#	Mistake	Do this instead
1	Counting views, leads or sign-ups as demand	M10 Behavioral Commitment Test; always report the denominator (rule 03).
2	Scaling a campaign while providers cancel	M40 capacity gate; throttle acquisition (rule 15).
3	Treating an interview "yes" as a commitment	P02, then L06.

#	Mistake	Do this instead
4	Running several Plays at once on one market	Name the binding constraint (§2) and work on that axis first.
5	Rolling a weak territory into a strong average	Separate Positions per territory; P27 for every new one.
6	Using a Gambit to rescue weak evidence	S02 Disconfirm first (rule 14).
7	Granting exclusivity to get a partner started	M42 non-exclusive test; G07 only with approval and a performance floor.
8	Letting a Campaign result rewrite the Market Position	Send an Impact Signal; the Market Manager decides in a Review.
9	Discounting an offer that misfits	P18 Offer Fit Reframe before G06.
10	Reusing consent for a different purpose	Rule 02; record permission and contact owner (A19).
11	Paying field workers per positive lead	Pay for completed, QA-accepted Missions. An honest “no demand” is good work.
12	Debating whether to stop	Set the stop rule when the Line starts (L16).
13	Reporting a pilot result as a market result	State the transfer limits and the population it covers.
14	Asking a busy executive to read 20 transcripts	Glance → Brief → Review → Investigation → Dossier; lead with what changed and the decision needed.

Tips by role

Role	Tips
Market Manager	Start every Review by naming the binding constraint. Read Impact Signals as evidence, not instructions. Keep “no action” on the list of options.
Campaign Manager	Write the hypothesis, control and stop rule before launch. Close your Case on what it proved, not on what it implies for the market.

Role	Tips
Market Architect	Log refusals and negative findings as carefully as successes. Stop the moment a site or participant feels unsafe. Never claim an affiliation you don't have.
Sponsor	Approve envelopes, not tactics. Ask for the denominator and the counterfactual on every result. Own each scale decision before its gate date.
Agents	Start from the Recommended next step and check its reason. When a person overrides you, ask for the reason; it trains the next release.

17 How the playbook changes

Topic	How it works
Status	CANDIDATE → LAB (synthetic or consented evidence) → SHADOW (observed in real programs, no effects) → LIMITED (expressly authorized, bounded use) → QUALIFIED (demonstrated for a defined situation and environment). Status is per context: qualified in one city or channel is not qualified in the next.
Proposing a new item	Describe the gap from a real case → park any high-consequence effect → draft a candidate in Labs → rehearse in market worlds with holdouts and a no-action baseline → independent evaluation → shadow → limited use → qualification.
Feedback	Every override, stop, escalation and outcome is recorded. Items with high override or stop rates are reviewed first.
Versioning	Every item has a version. Reviews pin the versions they used, so past decisions can be reproduced.
Two kinds of learning	Operational learning updates Positions and Cases. Institutional learning changes methods, and only through the School's release. One successful pilot never promotes a method by itself.

Topic	How it works
Cadence	Quarterly School release (new and revised items, defects, known failures, regressions); yearly review of the full catalogue.

Decisions before v1.0

These came up while turning the workbook into this playbook. Each needs an owner and a decision.

1. **ID collisions.** Workbook market archetypes A01–A16 collide with Actions H-A01–A60, and evidence gates G0–G5 collide with Gambits. This playbook uses AR01–AR16 and Gate 0–5; adopt the same in the registry.
2. **State names drift in the workbook cases.** Cases use SUPPORTING, INTERESTED, TESTING, DIFFERENT BUYER and “probable”, which are not states in the MP1–MP7 models. Use canonical states only and put nuance in the evidence.
3. **Two stance lists.** Workbook §1 lists “Listen-first / Test / Activate / Build / Expand / Protect”; §5 defines eight stances. This playbook keeps the eight.
4. **Stage grouping.** Workbook §9.2 puts P27 Geography Transfer under Explore and P32 under both Scale and Any stage. This playbook groups Plays by where they usually start (P27 Scale, P32 Any stage). Confirm.
5. **P26 has no review Line.** The workbook sends P26 Permission and Compliance Review only to L16 Reframe or Stop, so every compliance question defaults to a stop. This playbook uses L13 steps 1–2 on entry and L16 only for live breaches. Consider a dedicated compliance-review Line.
6. **Boilerplate cards.** In the workbook, every Move, Line, Gambit and Action shares the same “avoid”, “required evidence”, “who decides” and example text. This playbook wrote specific ones; each needs review by the owning role.
7. **Stance compatibility is new.** The workbook has only a Position → default stance table. Matrices 7.1, 7.2, 7.6 and the §12 stance column are proposals; test them against the cases and Lab worlds before relying on them.
8. **Thresholds.** Appendix B values are placeholders. Set them from pilot evidence (workbook §25.2), never from imported global conversion rates.
9. **Pick the v1 core.** The workbook recommends 8–12 Plays with full executable contracts rather than claiming all 32. Suggested first slice, matching workbook §26.14: Plays P02, P07, P13, P19, P23, P26, P30, P32 and Lines L02, L04, L06, L09, L11, L12, L16, L17, L18. Everything else stays CANDIDATE in Lab.
10. **Net-value checks on Gambits.** Confirm the method for each card’s net-value test, especially G05, G06 and G11, where the loss shows up after the visible gain.

Appendices

A Glossary

On screen	Registry term	Meaning
Market unit	Market Position identity	Principal × offer × buying archetype × job × territory × route × time horizon.
Position	Market Position (MP1–MP7)	The evidence-backed, uncertainty-qualified state of one market unit on seven axes.
Binding constraint	—	The axis that most limits progress now; it sets the default stance.
Stance	Stance	The short-term professional behaviour chosen for the current situation.
Strategy	Strategy	The market outcome the principal intends to cause.
Play	Play	A recognized market situation and its response family.
Line	Line	A conditional, time-aware plan of Moves with branches, stop rules and a done test.
Move	Move	One purposeful intervention meant to change the Position.
Gambit	Gambit	A bounded give/get concession with a capped loss and a named approver.
Action	Action	One auditable, logged effect.
Mission	Mission	A scoped assignment for a human Market Architect or an agent, with conduct, evidence and completion rules.
Market Architect	Market Architect	A qualified Hipstraw human field or domain specialist.

On screen	Registry term	Meaning
Review	Review	A governed decision event that reconciles evidence, updates a Position or Case, and sets attention and disposition.
Impact Signal	Market Impact Signal	A validated observation sent to the owner of an affected Position; never a direct state change.
Evidence gate	Gate 0–5 (registry G0–G5)	The evidence required to move between Explore, Develop, Build and Scale.
Market type	Archetype AR01–AR16 (registry A01–A16)	A recurring market-system pattern, not a demographic stereotype.
Verified outcome	Verified outcome	A consequential effect reconciled to an authoritative source.
Program · Cohort · Faculty · School	Same	A finite client engagement · a multi-party learning experience · a continuing market mandate · the institution that builds and qualifies methods.

B Example thresholds and limits

Example values for a first operating slice. Each mandate sets its own; review them quarterly and replace them with pilot evidence.

Setting	Example value	Notes
Participant contact	One open request per participant per principal; at most 2 follow-ups	Rule 09; one contact owner per participant
Opt-out propagation	Immediate for automated channels; within 1 hour for human ones	Rule 19
Response window	5 business days	Then one follow-up, then escalate

Setting	Example value	Notes
Capped test without sponsor approval	Up to $2,500 per test and $10,000 per market unit per month	Above: sponsor approves (A49)
Gambit approval	Always a named approver	Max loss above $25,000: investment authority
Capacity gate	Cancellations ⩽ 10% and fill rate ⩾ 85%, trailing 2 weeks	Breach: throttle acquisition (A43)
Reserved-capacity utilization (G05)	⩾ 60%	Below for 2 weeks: shrink the reservation
Contribution stop	Negative incremental contribution in 2 consecutive cohorts	Stop spend; L12
Repeatability (Gate 3)	⩾ 2 independent cohorts or periods	
Recurring objection	Same objection from ⩾ 3 qualified prospects	Triggers P18
Evidence freshness	Field evidence older than 90 days is stale for Activate or Expand decisions	Active units: weekly Market Review
Exclusivity (G07)	1 territory, ⩽ 6 months, with a performance floor	Legal approves
Field safety	Any worker safety incident stops the Mission at once	Review within 1 business day
Conversion and CAC targets	None imported	Set from pilot evidence (workbook §25.2)

C Sources

Document	Used for
Hipstraw Market Mastery Master Workbook v0.2, 13 October 2026	All IDs, the 20 hard rules, Positions, Stances, the Strategy, Play, Line, Move, Gambit and Action catalogue, market types, gates, decision rights, agent organization and the worked cases.
Kozmo Invoice Alpha Playbook v0.1, October 2026	Structural pattern only: quick picker, compatibility matrices, situation finder, card format, worked-case format, upkeep. No Kozmo method, permission or certification transfers to Hipstraw.